



Jorgen & His Times

Written by
Esther Petersen



Nov 3, 1986

To my dear grandson Darcy Krichman

This copy would be incomplete without
a quotation from God's Word of Truth.

Do you not know that the runners
in a race all run, but only one receives
the prize? Run in such a way
that you may attain it.

1 Cor. 9:24

With much love and prayers
for your success in life

Your grandmother
Esther Marie Petersen

To my dear grandson - Kenneth Krohnard

I had thought to autograph this copy - I leave you with a thought from God's Holy Writ; the One by whom we live and breathe and exist, the Supreme Sovereign of the Universe.

For Jehovah himself gives wisdom; out of his mouth there are knowledge and discernment. And for the upright ones he will treasure up practical wisdom; for those walking in integrity he is a shield, by observing the paths of judgment, he will guard the very ~~being~~ of his loyal ones. In that case you will understand righteousness and judgment and uprightness, the entire course of what is good.

In Remembrance
Your Grandmother

Nov 3, 1986

To my dear daughter Margaret Elaine Krohn

This copy would not be complete without
a quotation from God's Word of Truth.

Trust in Jehovah with all your heart
and do not lean on your own understanding.

In all your ways take notice of him,
and he himself will make your paths straight.

Prov. 3: 5-6

With much love to you and yours,

your mother

Ester Elaine Petersen

For my daughter, Joy
Without her generous contribution of
time and energy spent at her typewriter,
this biography might not have come into
print. My deepest gratitude and love.

a l s o

For my nephew, George Dalgarno
It was by his urging that I was inspired
to share this family history of our
common heritage. Many thanks and with
fond affection to you and my readers.
May all family members feel that each
individual is a link in an endless chain
of continuity.

JORGEN AND HIS TIMES

written by
Esther Petersen

Part I

My father Jorgen was born in the year 1882 in Fyn, Denmark. His birth was a bit of an unexpected event to his parents, as they were well into the middle years of life. They had thought that their family was complete, they had three half grown daughters, the youngest of whom was ten at their brother's arrival. A son, to carry on the family name and to maintain the line of continuity was therefore a cause for much rejoicing.

The father, named Jens was a carpenter by trade, at this work he was able to provide a modest living for himself and his family. In his appearance he was tall and gangling, his face was stern and kind, his blue eyes had a habitual seriousness about them but when he smiled, which was but rarely, they could be very tender. He was a strict disciplinarian to his children, he taught them by both precept and inclined to be somewhat intolerant of any lapse of his high expectations from his family members, the code by which he lived was just if rigid. He allowed little provision for human failings and short comings. He truly revered God's Word and his life was a testimony to his faith. He was the undisputed head of his household and his word was law, harsh though it might have seemed at times. His wife and children at no time sought to protest or challenge that law. The family felt itself a secure entity under that authoritarian headship.

He and his family were staunch Lutherans in their religion and they faithfully attended the Sunday morning services. They sat quietly and listened attentively as the black frocked vicar, from his lofty perch, mouthed his sententious platitudes and he particularly emphasized all the furies of a literal burning hell that awaited the unrepentant sinner. Jorgen, as a small child shuddered with fear at this awful thought. In later life he was to repudiate much of these early teachings, perhaps he came to recognize the bigotry and the hypocrisy of so many of the learned clergy, some of whom used their position as a political podium, mainly to favor the ruling class and to keep the ordinary laborer in subordination to his betters.

The same clergymen considered themselves as quite superior to the average working man and one of the elite, certainly in the same class

as the political and ruling elements and to those ends they used their influence. It was impressed upon Jorgen early in life, that when he was in the presence of one of these august personages, he was always to remember to bow and address him as “Sir”.

By the time that Jorgen was four or five years old, his three sisters were finished school and they had left home and were working out. School was compulsory and to the average working man’s child it was over at the age of fourteen. From then on, the youngster was considered an adult and capable of making his or her own living. The young person might apprentice and work at a trade or work for one of the landowners, in which case he would be required to sign a lease, that bound him to work for the landowner for a period of two to four years. There could be a certain amount of exploitation in this arrangement, as for example, the landowner might treat his help fairly enough for the most part of the agreed term of contract but in the last six month period, before the contract expired, the unscrupulous employer, might very well, make such unreasonable demands on his help and become so nasty and vindictive in his attitude, with the sole purpose of making his help quit, and so break their contract and in so doing they forfeited their years wages.

This was in the day before the different labor unions were organized and the ordinary working man feared to protest working conditions and low wages at the expense of his job.

The big land holders still held sway, they were the titled nobility of the land. Their vast estates were organized almost on the feudal scale, that is to say, that the land was divided into various small parcels of land and they in turn were leased out to the tenant farmers. They worked the land and were paid by receiving a share of the crops and livestock but under that arrangement they could never hope to own the land that they worked.

It wasn’t till later on, in the early part of the twentieth century and under a newly formed socialist government, that these hereditary estates were confiscated and the land was broken up into small

landholdings of less than one hundred and fifty acres in size, enough to provide a living for a man and his family. An enterprising man could hope to own the land that he farmed.

During the last decades of the nineteenth century commerce, industry and finance flourished and the dairy farming and the co-operative movement were greatly expanded. After 1880 the then newly organized Social Democratic movement played a prominent role in the Danish labor movement and in the struggle for a Democratic constitution. A new century was opening up, the age of technology. It was to be an age of such scientific achievement of which Jorgen and his generation never dreamed of and which his grandchildren would take for granted. The twentieth century, just then opening up, was to be a transitional period wherein Europe and the Americas leaped from an agrarian society to the atomic age, a tremendous leap! Not even the vivid imagination of Jules Verne could encompass the wonders of the coming age.

Jorgen, in his eighty years was to live to see a time when with the flick of a switch, he could watch on his television screen, events that were taking place in any part of the globe.

He would be able to be transported thousands of miles in a very few hours via jet air travel, quite a contrast to the seven days that it took, the first time he crossed the Atlantic to America.

Jorgen's childhood days were carefree, his parents though strict in his upbringing, were loving and his older sisters pampered him and spoiled him, whenever they and their families came home for a short visit. Jorgen felt secure and happy within the family circle, although at the rare times he felt the rod of correction as it was wielded by his disciplinarian father, who was a firm believer in the adage, "spare the rod and spoil the child". The father remembered to temper justice with mercy. Jorgen's parents were simple and unaffected people, unpretentious, direct and honest in all of their dealings with family, friends and neighbours. They had their required seven years of education, there was no illiteracy in Denmark. They read few books,

beyond their Bible and church literature. They accepted without question, the dogma and doctrine of the Lutheran teachings.

Their wants and needs were simple, coffee with their friends on a Sunday afternoon, a picnic with friends and neighbours, by a lake on a summer's day, a visit to one of their married daughters and her family. On very rare occasions, there might be a trip into a town, a little larger than their village. Little Jorgen would be entranced at the sights and sounds, of the people going in and out of the different stores, of the horses and buggies on the streets and of being taken by his parents to a little coffee shop where they had such fabulous layer cakes with whipped cream topping. To the wide eyed boy, all this was sheer delight, a day to remember.

Jorgen's home was of grey fieldstone with a thatched roof, whereon a pair of storks used to build their nest and rear their young. Every year these pilgrims from a far off country by the Nile came unerringly to their abode. What an instinct!

The interior of the home was small and cozy, with its white scoured plank floors, whitewashed walls and the heavy dark oak hand made furniture that Jorgen's father had fashioned, doweled rather than nailed together. Jens was a craftsman in his trade and also a bit of a perfectionist. His son was to inherit that trait.

The windows of the house, which were small and many paned, were kept sparkling clean and rows of pink and red geraniums bloomed on the dark broad sills. There were few pictures on the walls, one was of Jorgen's parents, taken on their wedding day. The groom was in a frock coat and he wore a benign expression on his face. He was seated and his bride stood beside him with one of her hands resting on his shoulder. She wore a high necked, long sleeved dress, a bit austere. Her face was anything but austere, but sweet and gentle, a lovely face. Her eyes were tender and compassionate. There were a couple of gold framed pictures of a Biblical nature, one was of Jesus, with a lamb on one arm and a shepherd's crook on the other. On his face was a look of deep caring, as he devotedly watched over his

flock. The second picture fascinated small Jorgen and he repeatedly entreated his mother to tell him the story of the “Guardian Angel”. The picture showed two small children, a boy and a girl, standing on the very brink of what appeared to be a bottomless abyss and gazing downwards. The guardian angel was standing behind the children and protectively spreading his wings above their heads.

Jorgen’s mother had a love of the beautiful and she instilled the appreciation for these things into her son. She did exquisite handwork, some of which adorned their simple home and gave it that extra touch of graciousness. She lovingly tended her small flower garden where she grew pansies and forget-me-nots, pink, white and yellow daisies, purple asters, blue delphiniums, fragrant tall lillies and her rose garden was her special delight, a garden is a lovely thing! God wrought.

Behind the house Jorgen’s father had planted three fruit trees, an apple tree, a pear tree and a cherry tree. They bore their fruit in due season and provided shade from the hot summer sun. On a Sunday afternoon, during the warm days of spring and summer, the three of them would sit, Jorgen together with his parents, while they talked of the discourse that the minister had delivered that same morning. Jorgen listened attentively, he was an introspective and precocious boy, which was probably the result of spending most of his time in the company of adults. He knew what obedience was from earliest childhood. He loved his mother and he loved and feared to displease his father. He was prone to emotional outbursts and at times he felt his father’s strong restraining hand.

Jorgen began school at the age of seven, for him it was a momentous occasion and his first real association outside of his quiet home life. He felt strange and ill at ease in his new surroundings as he timidly looked around at his classmates, nearly all of whom were blue eyed, fair skinned and with flaxen hair. The girls were dressed in dark serviceable tunic types of dresses and these were topped by print pinafores. The boys were dressed much as Jorgen himself was, they wore sturdy dark grey pants and jackets over blue or brown shirts

and grey, brown or blue caps topped their fair hair. Both boys and girls wore black lace up boots and heavy black hand knit socks or stockings. They were a ruddy cheeked lot of children.

Jorgen looked at the girls with their long plaits of braided hair hanging down their backs, they shyly looked back at him and giggled and whispered together. The boys, who had assembled in one group in a corner opposite of the girls, tended to ignore him, all the while doing a great deal of shuffling of feet and elbowing one another a bit, while all the while keeping an anxious eye on the teacher.

The teacher, a young man of about twenty five years, seemed quite unaware of the speculative looks directed at him as he arranged the books on his desk. He had an intelligent looking face, not without a glint of humor in his bright blue eyes. He liked teaching and the thought of instilling knowledge and an appreciation for learning into young and malleable minds, truly appealed to him. He taught his pupils thoroughly and well. He seldom resorted to the rod of correction, his students respected and liked him and they were eager to gain his approval. His was the iron hand in the velvet glove.

The one bright spot in the very routine school days, was when, in the half hour before dismissal for the day, the teacher would read to his class, mostly of adventures and exploits of men of fame and renown, of far away places, across seas and continents and to the very ends of the earth. Jorgen would listen spellbound and he dreamed of one day travelling to and seeing some of these places.

In later years he did fulfill that dream, as a young man he crossed the Atlantic seven times, crossed the American continent from sea to shining sea.

Jorgen's school years passed uneventfully, he was a good average student and he applied himself to his studies. He would not have dared to come home with a report of less than average grades and he was made very aware that his parents expected decorum from him, in all respects.

Through all of his school years, Jorgen had one really close boyhood friend, by the name of Holger. These two friends had much in common, the same family background, they shared the same interests and they dreamed the same dreams, that of some day, coming to America, the land of hope and promise.

Jorgen and Holger complemented one another by being of different temperaments, Jorgen was inclined to be intense with a quick temper, easily aroused and a bit of an introvert.

Holgar was the distinct opposite with a placid nature, outgoing and always popular with the group. There were times when Jorgen's quick temper would get him into difficulties but Holger would be there to defend his friend. The friends feeling for one another was purely platonic and might be compared to a Jonathan and David relationship, a binding tie that continued throughout all the days of their lives, well over three score years.

At the age of fourteen Jorgen had finished school and he was ready to enter the workaday world. He now had to prepare for confirmation, this was considered a part of the final graduation exercise from school. In preparation for this event, the students were thoroughly drilled by the local clergyman, in the Apostles Creed and the doctrine of the Lutheran church. Theology was taught by rote and the class learned by rote, few if any were convinced or converted by what they heard.

Jorgen was of an introspective nature and he did at times meditate on the deeper things of life. He pondered, that if God were almighty and all-powerful, the source of all creation, why did He allow so many of the conditions that only brought misery and privation to His creatures? God had not made humankind as robots or automatons, that would have no choice as to their course of action. God had made them in his own image and given them a measure of God like attributes, to be able to reason, to use their intelligence to observe, to discern, to choose - above all the freedom to choose for themselves!

Having completed the required years of schooling and having been confirmed by profession of faith, Jorgen's future was decided on by his father. He was to be contracted out to a small landholder. This contract was for four years. Jorgen was disappointed, he had hoped to join his father in the carpentry trade, he had more of an aptitude toward the use of the saw and hammer than that of the plow handle and the pitch fork.

His work for the next three years, seemed in a sense dull and rather monotonous, it consisted mainly of hard work and it didn't allow much time for pleasure or recreation. He was allowed Sunday afternoons free and those he spent in going home to visit his parents for a couple of hours. Once in awhile he might go to visit one of his married sisters. He enjoyed the company of his nephews and nieces, some of whom were close to his own age.

His friend Holger worked on the adjoining farm, so the boys saw one another occasionally. They had worked for six months and they had saved enough money to buy themselves each a bicycle. They would get together on Saturday evenings and talk over their plans for the future and it was at this time that they agreed on that they would emigrate to America. They would save their money and make their plans accordingly. They had heard that the "New World" as it was called, was truly a land of golden opportunity for the venturesome, that fame and fortune were within the grasp of those who were willing to apply themselves to hard work.

America was a land where there was no class distinction, where even the president was called "Mister".

The farmer for whom Jorgen worked was a kind employer but firm. He expected his hired help to do a conscientious job whether under supervision or not and he didn't tolerate any laziness or slovenliness.

Jorgen was only one of the hired help, there were three men and three girls. The men worked the fields and took care of the stock, horses, cattle, sheep and pigs. The girls did the milking, took care

of the dairy, looked after the poultry flock and cared for the garden. At times they were expected to help the mistress of the house with cleaning and cooking. The work was hard, the hours were long and the wages were low.

The days were long, every one was expected to be up at five thirty. Jorgen would help to feed the stock and get the milk cows in their stanchions, ready for the girls to milk them. Breakfast was at seven o'clock and by that time, Jorgen was good and hungry and he had quite an appetite for the bowl of oatmeal porridge, a slice or two of rye bread with margarine together with a cup of weak coffee. The hired help did not sit at the same table as the family. The social lines were very distinctly drawn and except for receiving their work orders, there was little, if any communication between the landowners and his hired hands. Communal living did not serve to promote communal thinking, quite the reverse!

Life was not all work and no play and just the fact that Jorgen and Holger were young and healthy, full of a spirit for adventure, was a pleasure in itself. There were the times when the young people from neighboring farms would all gather at a lake for a picnic.

It was an opportunity for the girls and the young women to show off their summer finery, pastel colored dresses and hats. The boys, being more warmly dressed, soon shed their coats in favor of comfort. There was much laughter and good natured shouting to one another as the boys vied for the favor of one particular girl, usually the prettiest and most vivacious of the group. Soon there were a dozen or so small boats on the lake with mostly couples in each one.

In the meantime, others of the young people were gathering around the rustic wooden tables and benches, spreading the gaily colored checkered tablecloths on the tables and depositing their well laden hampers. There was quite an assortment of food, fresh buns, fried chicken, hard boiled eggs, different cheeses and cold cuts, pickled herring, pickles and various cakes and doughnuts, altogether a bountiful repast and much appreciated. There was a small wooden

shed where a person might take shelter in case a sudden shower came up. In it was a heavy old cast iron stove where one could heat or cook some food or make a pot of coffee. The delicious aroma of freshly made coffee was beginning to drift over the picnic grounds. Everyone was ravenous and much good humored repartee accompanied the meal.

There was one girl that Jorgen particularly liked, of the three girls that worked together with Jorgen and the two young men. She was the youngest of the group and just sixteen. She was shy and all the conversation that Jorgen had had with her was at the odd times, when on Sunday mornings they had walked together to church services. Her name was Lisa and Jorgen thought that she was beautiful, she was slight and slender, with soft brown hair and hazel eyes that shone out from under winged brows and they seemed to blend all the colors of the spectrum and merge into the midnight black of the irises, deep and fathomless.

The two were very young and very vulnerable and only once was Jorgen guilty of a slight indiscretion. He knew that Lisa had her room on the second floor, towards the back of the house and facing the vegetable garden and the raspberry patch. One evening at bedtime, Jorgen convinced himself that he was hungry and so he sought out the raspberry patch. From this vantage point he could see into Lisa's lighted window as she had not yet drawn her curtains. Jorgen picked a couple of handfuls of berries and watched and waited. Lisa got up from her chair, laid aside the book that she had been reading, probably her Bible and she turned back the covers off her bed. She stood in front of her dresser mirror and unbraided her long hair, till it fell in shining waves and it reached half way down of her back. Slowly she started to undress, first her skirt and loose print blouse, then her shoes and stockings.

She stood for a few moments as if in contemplation, reached for her nightdress and finished removing her undergarment of camisole and pantaletts. As she extended her arms over her head in order to slip into her nightdress, she stood for a moment, outlined in the light

behind her, in all of her naked beauty. She reached out to blow out the flame from her lamp. Jorgen felt a thrill of sheer delight, though not unmixed with a sense of shame of his subterfuge. He did not again resort to that violation and he kept his secret. In the three short years that he knew Lisa, he kissed her only once on her sweet, soft lips, a kiss of innocence and youth, to cherish and remember for a lifetime.

Jorgen had been brought up by a set of rigid moral standards, Christian conduct had been inculcated into him by his father. He was not unaware of some of the practices that went on behind the closed doors of the bedrooms that had been assigned to the young people with whom Jorgen worked. He saw the wooden clogs left outside the doors and he heard the stifled giggling, together with the subdued murmuring of the amorous couples. This custom, though not condoned, was not frowned on too severely. If a girl should be unfortunate to become pregnant as a result of her indiscretions, she would have her child and she most often was prepared to keep it, in spite of the cruel stigma of illegitimacy, that the social order of that era, imposed upon such a one. At times, the girl's mother or perhaps an older married sister might be relied upon, to care for the child, until such time as the girl could provide a home for her child, usually by marrying. Because of the rigid class distinction of the times, many young couples thought to make a new beginning for their families in a new environment, a truer climate, where they and their children, might be measured by their abilities rather than their connections. In a new land they might hope to realize this ambition. Some of these self same people emigrated to America, Australia and New Zealand. The children of these immigrants came to think of their parents native land as the "Old Country". In later years, when they visited the land of their origin, as they wandered through "God's Little Acre" they could trace their ancestry back, through the epitaphs on the tombstones for hundreds of years.

There were not too many of the ones that rested there, that had lived the Biblical life span of three score and ten years.

It was at a time, when tuberculosis had reached almost epidemic

proportions and many a family died within a few months of one another. The fourth horse, the pale one of the Apocalypse ran rampant. The white plague would be conquered in time but only to be replaced with other illnesses, as deadly. Influenza was to rear its ugly head, the dreadful aftermath of World War I, it killed twenty million people, the war killed fourteen million.

Jorgen's four years of apprenticeship were at an end. He was now eighteen, a man's estate. The year was nineteen hundred, he was to live to see a century of transition, unparalleled in all the preceding centuries of mans history. Jorgen little dreamed that he was living at the beginning of an era that was to transform the world, a whole new system of communication was opening up, it was in nineteen hundred and seven that the transatlantic wireless telegraph service was established for public use. Short wave radio was still to come, whereby a message could be transmitted around the world, to outer space itself, by means of orbital satellite. He would live to see the world enter the nuclear age, the first tremendous tests of the splitting of the atom, whereby man was able to reverse the process of creation by converting matter into energy. As a result of this accomplishment, man forgot to reckon, that his slave could become his master, a master, relentless and horrific, capable of the complete annihilation of the human race. Before the twentieth century was to end, man would have set foot on the moon. In factories, manufacturing everything from micro chips to giant equipment used in peace and war, automation would take the place of man power. Technology would be the watch word of the era, an era just opening up for Jorgen and his friend Holger.

The two eagerly collected and read the brightly colored brochures that were available on America, described in glowing terms, as a land of free enterprise, with equality for all and a land flowing with milk and honey, an Utopian dream!

No mention was made of an America, that had so recently freed it's slaves and where racial discrimination was very much a part of the social structure of the country. The American Constitution, as part of

it's Bill of Rights as laid down by the "Great Emancipator" Abraham Lincoln and claiming this nation, under God, shall have a new birth of freedom, and that government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth. Certainly, for the slaves, freedom did not mean the end of hardship and bitter persecution and from being owned by one master, they were now exploited by all men, because of their colour and their origin. The only work open to them was that of a menial.

These same people had their roots in African soil, they were to become part of the great melting pot, formed of widely varied immigrants, from every part of the globe, some from Europe and others from the Orient! It was nothing unusual to see a Chinese coolie and an Irish Catholic working side by side on a railway construction gang or an American Jew and a Russian nobleman serving tables in the same restaurant. America was a land of contrasts.

It was a time when with a little capital investment and some resourcefulness, a man might amass a fortune. Huge tracts of land were stripped of their prime timber. This was before reforestation was a requirement. The mines were worked with cheap labor and with little regard to safety regulations for the miners. The mine sites when depleted were left bare and desolate, a blight upon the landscape. The lumber barons and the mine owners got enormously wealthy and it was part of that wealth that controlled and directed the political elements of the land. It wasn't till later on when the unions organized, that wages and labor conditions improved.

America was still a challenge to the intrepid, a land where a person could find freedom from old hide bound traditions, the rigid class distinction, the lack of opportunity to advance or achieve beyond one's social or economic level.

With emigrating to America in view, Jorgen and Holger had diligently saved their wages, they were twenty three years of age and they felt mature enough to put their plans into action. After saying their goodbyes to friends and family, together with many admonitions

from their parents to remember that they were Christians and to conduct themselves accordingly, they completed their arrangements. They boarded, the Dannenborg, a small steamship, that was to take them as far as Liverpool, England.

The sailing across the North Sea was rough and most of the passengers spent their time below deck, being sea sick. Jorgen and Holger were among these and they were wretched enough not to venture up on deck often. The little Dannenborg pitched and heaved with the swell of the high rolling seas and the friends were hard put to it in order to keep their equilibrium on the slippery deck. In spite of feeling so raw and miserable from nausea, they looked in awe and wonder into the depths of giant foam crested waves that rose constantly into mountains and fell back into valleys that seemed as black as some Stygian world.

The Dannenborg was two days in crossing the North Sea and it dropped anchor in the harbor of Liverpool, a port of entry for sailing ships from around the globe. From the Dannenborg, most of it's passengers would transfer to the British vessel Britannia to make the Atlantic crossing.

There was to be a two day lay over, so Holger and Jorgen decided to explore some of the city. Liverpool was a city of many and varied industries and its mills and foundries spread over a large area of the city. The huge stacks from the factories belched out voluminous clouds of dark grey smoke, that hung over the city like a pall and its acrid smell stung the nostrils of the inhabitants. Such seems progress, that a few of the rich industrial barons that owned and held control over these projects made their wealth and lived in luxury at the expense of the thousands of laborers who were exploited, under paid, working conditions left much to be desired, with little if any regard for the safety of the ones who had to make a meager living through blood, sweat and tears.

The two young men were light of heart, inquiring of mind and full of zeal for the future that held such bright prospects for them. As they

set out on their course of exploration, they were careful to note and map their direction and street numbers as it would enable them to retrace their steps. They had been warned not to venture too far afield as no doubt they looked what they were, a couple of very raw country boys. They might very well have fallen prey to some unscrupulous characters. They had been told that they should carry only a small amount of money in their wallets or pockets. There were many pickpockets on the streets and they were very adept at their trade. Jorgen and Holger had been wary and they had secreted the bulk of their money into a pocket that was sewn inside of their belts. They felt secure in knowing that any would be thief would have to knock them unconscious and strip them before he would find any money.

As the two friends were caught up in the mainstream of the traffic, they could not help but marvel at the infinite variety of faces and costumes. There were people of every race and color, apart from the Caucasian, there were black, yellow and brown, some loitering, others purposefully striding on their way. It was absolutely bewildering to watch the people of such polyglot extraction, here a tall turbaned Hindu, there a squat Chinese with his queue, long and straight, also a swarthy skinned Arab, striding along in his burnoose.

Jorgen and Holger spoke of how interesting it might be, if they could know the background and the history that some of these people sprang from, such different racial origins and cultures from theirs. No doubt they too stood out in the crowd, with their blue eyes, rosy fair faces and light colored hair, a couple of innocents abroad surely!

They stopped to gaze in at some of the shop windows and their varied displays, all sorts of things, food and clothing, furnishings and lamps, china and crystal, jewels and silver, furs and leather goods, flowers and bric-a-brac, art and books. There seemed to be no end to the merchandise. They told one another that one day they might be wealthy enough to be able to buy some of these things.

In later years, by the time that these two young men had reached the state of affluence, whereby, they could gratify their desire for material

things, they found that the satisfaction that they derived from this, did not meet the expectations that they had hoped for. Far pastures are greener and values change over the years. The two friends passed open street stands and markets that presented a tumultuous quantity of wares, both foreign and domestic. There were oranges, lemons and olives from Spain, bananas from Jamaica, papayas from Central America, dates from India, tea from Ceylon, coffee from Brazil, coconut and pineapple from Hawaii, blue and green grapes from the sunny slopes of France and Italy. There was an abundance of domestic fruits and vegetables. There were the meat stalls where the hawkers proclaimed their products, beef from Canada, lamb from Australia, pork from Denmark and all kinds of fowl and seafood, also fish of every variety.

There were the booths that sold all kinds of trinkets to the tourists. There were souvenirs of every description, rings and bracelets, pins and locket, mostly of silver and set with semi precious stones. There were ivory fans from Japan, carved jade from India, silver and turquoise from Mexico, pearls from the Orient, opals from Australia. There were perfumes from France and tortoise shell combs and hair ornaments from Italy, together with the most beautifully embroidered shawls and head scarves from the Ukraine. Jorgen looked at all these lovely things with the desire to buy his mother a small gift of remembrance.

He settled for an embroidered and beaded book marker, and Holger, not to be outdone, bought his mother a little silver pin in the shape of a ship's anchor.

Satisfied with their purchases, the two discovered that they were famished. They looked for and found a small sidewalk restaurant that advertised pancakes, bacon and eggs and it showed an illustration of these on a sign in the window. Their problem of ordering was simplified, as neither of them knew any English and they constantly had to consult their Danish-English dictionary in order to make themselves understood by tradespeople and waiters. They had English tea for the first time and they were quite agreed on that they

much preferred the Danish coffee.

Jorgen was to often later on in his travels to seek out this particular restaurant and sit and think of the events that had transpired since the time that he and his friend had first sat there. The two might be divided by oceans and continents but they were always close in spirit and there is a kinship between certain individuals that transcends and surpasses most human relationships and experienced perhaps once in a lifetime.

The two friends decided that it was about time for them to return to their ship. They had fortunately marked a map of their meanderings, otherwise they could easily have encountered some difficulty in finding their way back to port. They had one small incident that they were uncertain of just how to cope with. A couple of young women, wearing flamboyant clothing, with lips painted very red and sooty looking eyes, approached them and spoke to them, together with ingratiating smiles and subtle gestures. The two young men, not understanding the language nor the full import of the invitation, looked startled and more than a little confused, merely smiled and passed on. The strange woman!

They were glad to get back to their ship without mishap. Some of the seamen greeted them with some rather raucous jokes and questions on “how they had made out on the town”.

Supper that night was stew and after their days excitement and tramping the city streets, both Jorgen and Holger were hungry enough to enjoy it. Supper was rounded off with plum pudding, an English dish.

Some of the other passengers that were seated around the table, told of some of their experiences, as they had taken in the city sights. One fellow had narrowly escaped from being run over by a dray team and wagon. A young Swede, named Sigurd, had been accosted by a procurer who also peddled hashish on the side and was at the same time on the lookout for unwary young men. Jorgen and Holger were

happy enough to retire to their cabin that night, small and cramped though it was, as they shared it with two Norwegians. The narrow bunks accommodated them nicely and they were asleep the instant that their heads hit the pillow.

The waking bell rang early, at five o'clock and they had to be up and about. They had hired on as ship's help in order to augment the fare for their passage. It was their job to set and wait on the breakfast tables, to collect and wash the breakfast dishes afterwards and to set the tables for the next meal. After this, they swept the floors and brought in and scraped the vegetables for the noontime meal.

They had a couple of hours of free time and they could go up on deck to get acquainted with some of their shipmates. They formed a few lasting relationships, among these was the ship's doctor, a middle aged man with a determined face that easily broke into a ready smile. Jorgen had need of the doctor's professional services, as he had developed a boil on his neck, just where the collar of his shirt rubbed, very sore and raw. Dr. Martin swabbed the boil, put a compress on it and told Jorgen to come back when it was ready to be lanced. Through this association, Jorgen got to know and appreciate the good doctor.

Doctor Martin had come aboard the *Britania* as ship's doctor, through his friendship and old school ties with Captain Richards. The two had become firm friends while attending the same British boarding school. James Richards had later joined the Royal Navy Academy and Gail Martin had interned in a London medical college. The doctor and the captain were busy and dedicated men, each to his own profession, each was a pioneer in his own particular field, men of courage and daring and the stuff of which heroes are made. The captain was hale and hearty with a bluff and friendly manner, well liked and respected by his men and crew. The doctor was a bit more reserved, very well read and a bit of a philosopher at heart. He was truly a good "Samaritan", preferring to establish his practice among the illiterate, the underprivileged, the poor and needy.

He had to be prepared for any emergency aboard ship, anything from an impacted tooth to an acute attack of gallstones or appendicitis. He had the potential for being a first rate surgeon and his diagnoses were quite remarkable in that day when xray was still in its earliest infancy. He worked to improve the xray tube. He used a tube in which the pressure is as low as possible, and in which the cathode is heated by an auxiliary electric current, it is essentially a thermionic vacuum tube. He was cited for his pioneering in this field.

The monotony of the voyage was unrelieved except for a break on Sunday mornings. The captain was also the chaplain of his ship. He led and conducted a religious service in the dining hall and the crew and the passengers congregated to listen to the service which was usually brief, mostly consisting of a psalm or two and a closing prayer, although at times, he would expound on a text, aptly chosen.

*“Those going down to the sea in ships,
Doing business on vast waters,
They are the ones that have seen the works of Jehovah
And his wonderful works in the depths”.*

Both of the friends had been brought up to have a deep respect for the teachings of God’s Word of truth. Jorgen grew to treasure the Bible that his parents had presented him with as a parting gift and in later years he was often to find comfort and solace through it’s well marked and thumbed pages. It sustained him in the troubled years to come.

The conduct of Jorgen and his friend was in marked contrast to some of the crew members with which they were thrown much in contact. Some of the crew would get together to play cards and have a few rounds of drinks. Their talk and jokes were rather bawdy and sometimes their games would end in a round of fisticuffs as feelings ran high or some had a drink or two too many. Drinking and gambling were two of the evils that the parents of the two young men

had warned them about so they wisely kept their distance. A man is known by the company that he keeps.

There was a young Swedish lad aboard by the name of Olaf Johansen. Olaf was a quiet boy who used to whistle merrily as he went about his chores, swabbing the decks and generally doing odd jobs that were at hand. The weather had been damp, chill and rainy and Olaf had developed a somewhat racking cough. The doctor ordered Olaf to bed but his condition continued to worsen and Doctor Martin diagnosed pneumonia. Olaf perspired profusely, coughed and gasped for most part of a week and in spite of the doctor's diligent care, he succumbed to his illness. This was some thirty years before the use of the wonder drug sulfa came into effect and medical science had little to combat pneumonia with and it was usually considered a terminal illness.

It was sad to think that Olaf's life was cut short in such an untimely end, that he would never again set foot on his native shore, that his parents were never again to greet their bright young son. Did he perhaps have a girl whom he loved and dreamed to make his wife? Olaf was buried at sea, wrapped in a white tarpaulin. As the captain commended his body to the deep with a short sermon,

*“As for mortal man his days are like those of green grass,
Like a blossom of the field is the way he blossoms forth.
For a mere wind has to pass over it, and it is no more”.*

Jorgen and Holger began to eagerly anticipate the end of their ocean voyage. The weather cleared and the sun shone brightly, the white crested waves seemed to advance and recede against the ship's sides, the water shone brilliantly deepest emerald green, fading to aquamarine and violet in the distance. The white gulls flew by in graceful arcs, dipping and soaring and shrieking their raucous cry. They expressed exultant freedom! The cry of the sea!

Jorgen crossed the Atlantic seven times, he was to see the Pacific only

once. He lived at Vancouver a short time. The turn in the weather seemed a good omen. They were about to embark on the shores of America. They had been told that the *Britania* would enter into New York harbor early the following morning and as dawn broke across the sky in radiant splendor, the two were up and leaning on the rail of the deck, in order to catch the first glimpse of the city of skyscrapers.

What a fantastic view that was to the two country boys, as they gazed in wonder and admiration as tower upon tower stood out in bold relief against the rising sun. New York was at that time a city of four million people and it was to grow to nearly twice that size in the next fifty years.

As the *Britania* plied steadily towards it's wharf, it passed near to Bedloes Island and Jorgen and Holger got their first view of the Statue of Liberty. Jorgen would never forget the thrill that he felt as he gazed at that colossal figure, representing a crowned woman in flowing robes, who held a torch aloft with her right arm and carried on her left arm a book inscribed with the words July 04, 1776. It stood there as it does today, one hundred years later and it faces out to sea, so as to meet the view of passengers on incoming ships. It is one of the largest statues in the world and it is more than three hundred feet from the bottom of the pedestal to the tip of the torch. The torch is lighted with electricity from within.

The statue conceived as a lasting gesture of international amity has become a world symbol of the United States and of democratic traditions. The spirit for which it stands is well expressed by the American writer Emma Lazarus, appearing on a tablet in the main entrance to the pedestal, the poem read in part,

*"Give me your tired, your poor,
Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free,
The wretched refuse of your teeming shore,
Send these, the homeless, tempest tost, to me,
I lift my lamp beside the golden door!"*

Jorgen was to experience the thrill of seeing this symbol of liberty twice more in his travels, but never again with the tremendous glow of pride and elation that he felt the first time that he saw it.

The friends stood on deck and watched as the *Britania* glided through a whole fleet of ships from every nation as their ensigns proclaimed as they fluttered in the rather stiff breeze that blew inland from the sea. There were the huge passenger liners, gleaming in their white paint, the grey and dun colored freighters carrying every kind of merchandise from every corner of the globe, the sleek trim yachts of the wealthy and an assortment of fishing boats, police patrols and ferry boats.

Finally came the moment that had been long awaited, the ship had docked, the gang plank was down and Jorgen and Holger set foot on American soil for the first time. To them the “golden door” had opened and they gladly accepted the open welcome that America offered its many immigrants.

As they passed through the busy customs, they were to observe a little of the tragic side of life. Some there were, that failed to pass the medical tests and so would be deported back to where they came from. There were tears and bitter disappointment where families and friends were so separated. Time alone would tell when and where, they would once again be united, perhaps never!

However, Jorgen and Holger had no such hold backs and they continued with their plans, which were to travel to the State of Washington. Holger had relations in that State, and he had written to them to inquire of what the prospects were for finding employment in that part of the country. He had received an invitation for himself and his friend to visit the Hansen family. This determined their destination and so their train carried them for days across vast stretches of plains and mountains, they marveled at the seemingly endless vistas of fields, lakes and rivers. The sunsets were fantastic in grandeur as they blazed against the evening skies, a whole

conflagration of color, burning with intensity, until in its splendor it slowly faded into saffrons and purples that throbbed with radiance and slowly receded into palest pinks and mauves, as the blue of the evening dusk overtook the last glimmer of gold from the sunsets afterglow. America the beautiful!

The friends were fortunate enough to have procured the two seats which faced one another at the end of the railway coach. They were able to join these at nighttime and so in this way they improvised a double bed, herd, but at least they could stretch out. The one inconvenience was that they got a draft whenever the conductor or some passenger passed through to the next coach.

The railway coaches were usually either too hot or too cold, the two friends used their heavy woollen overcoats as blankets and their packsacks served well as pillows for their heads. They were learning to adjust to some hardships. Their meals were a bit haphazard and consisted mainly of sandwiches and coffee. They had learned to say ham sandwiches, or at times, egg sandwiches. Whenever the train stopped for a few minutes at a station, either Holger or Jorgen would disembark long enough to order their rations. Sometimes they could vary their menu by being able to buy a hamburger with onions and pickles or a piece of apple pie. They occasionally treated themselves to an ice cream cone, bought from the “darkie” as he passed through the coaches with a tray of assorted chocolate bars, candy, fruit and of course ice cream cones in assorted flavours. That was the time of the nickel bar of candy.

Jorgen and Holger became friendly with a couple of young Swedes, by the names of Nels and Eric who had come from the Swedish town of Malmo. They had both served as apprentices, Nels as a cabinet maker and Eric as a newspaper man. They were full of high spirits, friendly and outgoing. They had quite a repertoire of songs and ballads that they were only too ready to perform for the amusement of their fellow travellers. Their little concerts certainly added a little touch of lightness to the trip and helped to ward off the feelings of depression and fatigue that sometimes assailed the young men during the long

nights. It was a time for contemplation and a re-examination of their values.

Nels's and Eric's travelling plans were to meet some cousins in the State of Minnesota and hopefully to get work there. Minnesota was a state largely settled by Swedish immigrants, who worked the fertile land and fished the teeming lakes and waterways. It was a very productive land indeed! America the bountiful. If Jorgen and Holger had not already bought their tickets to Washington, they might very well have been tempted to stop here and with the help of their newly found friends look for employment.

However, they decided to proceed with their afore laid plans. They said their good-byes to their Swedish friends and wished them well. As they continued their journey westwards and they were becoming a little more familiar with the language as they picked up some English words and phrases. They had learned a few basics such as "Hello" and "Good-Bye", besides "no thanks" and "yes please".

They had exchanged most of their Danish crowns into American dollars, so the currency was not a difficulty after they learned the value of the silver coins, nickels, dimes, quarters and fifty cent pieces.

They could buy a full course meal for fifty cents and a cup of coffee and a piece of pie for fifteen cents. They were frugal and watched their money carefully, the only luxury that they allowed themselves was the occasional purchase of a newspaper or a magazine. They looked at the pictures and the advertisements and from these to the printed matter underneath these and in so doing, they were able to puzzle out some of the meaning of the caption text. Together with the aid of their Danish-English dictionaries, they were working on their English. The young learn fast and it wouldn't be too long before they would be able to carry on a limited conversation.

Their train had reached Chicago, and there was to be a twelve hour stopover, time enough for the two to see a few city sights. They were carelessly strolling a side street, when they noticed that they were

being followed. They very discreetly looked back and they noted that an enormous negress doggedly pursued their footsteps. They were not sure whether her intention was, to rob them or seduce them. They decided that discretion was the better part of valor and when they came to the first corner, they beat a hasty retreat and popped into a shop aperture. They saw no more of the woman and they considered themselves fortunate to have escaped.

They were very naive in regards to the lures and guiles of the world but they were learning. They had been very strictly brought up by their parents and they took good heed of the counsel to avoid evil companions, because bad associations spoil useful habits.

Holger and Jorgen often spoke of their hopes and prospects and they eagerly anticipated meeting the Hansens. It would be so pleasant to be able to talk freely to someone in their own language, someone who could understand their need for getting established in their new environment.

As they neared their destination the land became more flat and arid looking, real cattle ranching country. They saw great herds of cattle grazing the prairies and here and there a horse-back rider, dressed in what looked to be leather leggings, fringed and also they had some medallion like metal ornaments on them. These cowboys, as they came to know them, wore huge hats on their heads, which looked almost like umbrellas, which purpose they indeed served for at times when it rained. The cowboys faces were as brown as Mexicans, their skin weathered from sun and wind. As the train passed by, the riders would raise their hats and wave them around in a circle above their heads and smile and call a greeting to all aboard the long line of passenger cars.

The spirit of the West, ever friendly and hospitable. They were to come to know and love it well! In the years to come, this is where they would sink their roots, Holger in the State of Washington and Jorgen in the province of Alberta. As they neared the end of their destination and approached the small city of Spokane, the area became more

settled and as some of the land was irrigated, it produced well, beautiful crops of fresh green alfalfa and the fruit orchards were a thing of beauty, as they blossomed in great masses of pink and white. It was May and the weather was sheer delight. The days were filled with liquid sunshine, warm but not hot, with now and then a gentle breeze, cool and refreshing. The rainfall was minimal and it was the season before the terrifying cyclones, that ripped and tore everything in their destructive paths.

Jorgen looked across the fields and he could see the farmers at work cultivating their land, he and Holger were amazed to see one man handle as many as thirty two horses at one time, five spans of six horses abreast, with two lead horses in the very front. It must have been quite a feat to handle that many reins at one time without getting them tangled or twisted. It took four men in order to harness and unharness the horses.

This was still before mechanization took over with tractors and steam driven combines. Cars were still a novelty, the roads were mostly gravelled and did not give much more room than for two vehicles to pass one another. The horse and buggy were still much in usage and they could get over terrain, such as marshy land and narrow rough trails, creeks and rivers, where it was impossible to drive a car. It was still a time when a team of horses on the road would shy at an approaching auto-mobile and unless the driver of the buggy or the wagon, held a tight rein, a runaway team would tear down the road and it might end up almost anywhere, in the ditch or against a fence. The driver would consider himself lucky, if he escaped unhurt and his vehicle remained upright.

Finally, for Jorgen and Holger, it was journey's end! They were greeted warmly by the Hansens who met them at the depot, in preparation for taking the newcomers home with them. The luggage was loaded into the back of the buckboard which was hauled by two lively high spirited chestnut colored horses. The team trotted briskly along and from the high seat on which Jorgen and Holger were perched, they got an excellent view over the country side. They passed homesteads,

some were made of logs and there were a couple of sod shanties. These had served as homes for the earliest pioneers. These early settlers were a hardy breed, independent and resourceful with a true love of the land that they owned and worked.

Mr. Hansen and his two boys Sven and Harold, told that this was largely a settlement of people of Danish and Norwegian extraction with a sprinkling of Finnish and Icelandic parentage. They were mostly second generation people but they held unto the “old land” costumes and spoke often in their mother language. The older members of the community still had nostalgic memories of their native land. Some there were, who made the return journey to the land of their birth, they stayed for a few months, visited their friends and relations and discovered that a revelation had taken place, concerning their feelings and attitudes.

Gone was the sense of assimilation that had bound them to the old culture and traditions of bygone centuries. They found that they had emerged with a freer more liberal spirit, that their horizons had broadened considerably. They finally recognized and acknowledged their adopted home, theirs by free choice, as the land of promise for themselves and their posterity, a fertile land in which to sink their roots for all time.

Those were the days when a man could preempt a homestead by making a claim, breaking up so many acres and residing a given length of time on his preemption. Jorgen was to take advantage of this provision at a later date. In the meantime, he hoped to get acquainted with some of his countrymen.

The two young men were soon hired on as ranch hands but at different locations from one another. They found the ways of this strange new country quite unfamiliar to what they had been accustomed and they had much to learn.

The distances seemed so great and there were extensive tracts of land that were sparsely populated. There were the wild prairie animals

and birds, there were the coyotes, the badgers and the prairie dogs, besides the prairie chickens, the partridges and the pheasants, just to mention a few. It was a prolific land, yielding sustenance in abundance for so many living creatures. The diggers, such as the badgers or gophers, that burrowed their holes in the prairie sod, could be quite a hazard for the unwary horseback rider, that is, if the horse stuck his foot in one of the holes and broke his leg. There were also the rattlesnakes that would lie curled up in the sun and could poise itself for a deadly poisonous strike in an instant, though it rarely struck without warning. It had a unique set of rattles at the end of its tail and when it was alarmed it sounded these.

Jorgen and Holger soon learned to sit astride one of the more gentle of the ranch horses and after a few spills and tumbles from the barebacked horses, they gained confidence and were allowed to use the saddles on their mounts.

In time, they grew to love the thrill of a fast gallop on a spirited horse, it was with a sense of real exhilaration to ride and feel the wind in their faces and to hear the drum of their horses hoofs as they covered the miles.

A man could become very attached to his horse, in fact he often considered his horse as his best friend, even to the extent that his life might depend on the instinct of his animal. It has been proven more than once, that when a rider had been lost in a sudden and blinding snowstorm, not knowing in which direction to turn, by the act of giving his horse free rein and in so doing and in trusting in his horse's instinct to find his way home to his own corral.

In those days it was considered almost a capital crime to steal a person's horse, as at times it was sometimes a man's only means of transportation and he could die from lack of water and physical exhaustion if stranded on foot far from populated areas. A horse thief was accounted as a low down, good for nothing scoundrel and if caught at his stealing in the early pioneering days, he would often pay for his crime by being swung over a limb of a nearby tree until

dead. This sort of harsh treatment was as a rule meted out by outlaw bands. Horses were few and mules and oxen were used in their place.

There were the untamed wild horses, called cayuses, Indian ponies, which probably had their ancestry and origin from the animals that the early Spaniards brought to America, especially Mexico. From there they ranged through the central and western states. These ponies were smaller than the average horse but exceedingly tough and hardy.

It happened one day, that Jorgen was riding into town in order to pick up a few supplies for himself, it was a good hour's ride by road. He thought to himself, that he could cut that time in half, if he only dared to detour by taking his horse across the railway bridge that spanned a river that ran at the bottom of a deep ravine, a distance of about a thousand feet.

Jorgen looked at the far side of the bridge, listened to hear if he could detect any hum on the track or the sound of a far off whistle or hoot. There was no sound, so after a moments hesitation and with a spirit of daring and adventure, Jorgen carefully holding the reins of the bridle loosely in his hand, led his pony the first few steps. It was a tricky business as the pony had to be sure footed in order to step securely and regularly on the planks of the bridge. The planks were eight inches apart, one false step could have spelt disaster, a broken leg or a frantic animal and a panic stricken Jorgen. However, after about ten anxious moments, Jorgen could breathe a sigh of relief as he set foot on solid ground once more. It was a daring and useless escapade and one that he didn't repeat.

As Jorgen continued on his way into town, he was met by a wagon load of Indians, father, mother and four or five children, all dressed in a varied assortment of clothing. The man wore a fringed buckskin jacket and buckskin pants. The two boys were dressed much like their father and they all three wore their long black hair in heavy braids which hung down their backs. The mother and her little girls wore bright colored and flowered calico dresses and shawls. On their

feet, they wore beautifully embroidered and beaded moccasins.

The family was a hardy looking bunch and they stared stoically at Jorgen, who stared curiously back and greeted the family with a friendly “hello”.

These Indian people were much different from the impression that Jorgen had had from history and hearsay and the wild west books, fully illustrated with savage looking painted redskins, complete with wampum, deer skin clothing and headdresses of eagle feathers.

The many different tribes of native Indians that had once possessed the land and had fought one another fiercely over the domain that they claimed for their own, were no more.

The buffalo that had once roamed the plains by the millions and provided ample food for the Indians, were extinct, slaughtered by the thousands by the white man’s thunder-guns. The early traders brought further corruption by supplying the natives with liquor in return for their valuable furs.

To add to the demoralizing effect of liquor consumption the white man was also the cause of epidemic diseases, such as smallpox and influenza, which could spread like wildfire through a village or encampment, the rate of deaths was very high as the Indians had little if any resistance to the white man’s illness. Where at one time, the American Indian had been free to enjoy his nomadic way of life, to call the wilderness his own, to fish, to hunt and ride the prairie on his wild half broken bronc, to worship as he pleased, he was now deprived of most of these things by being herded into reservations, his old free lifestyle was a thing of the past, he was subject to the white man’s law.

If resentment brooded in some of the hearts of these people that had been dispossessed, it showed only in dull compliance to the white man’s laws and in an apathy of look and manner. A subjugated people might at times show a spirit of rebellion but it is like a brief

flame, soon obliterated by an inexorable force and the Indian was to be forever a vanquished race, under privileged and exploited.

Jorgen enjoyed the sense of freedom that this new country offered. There was plenty of opportunity to carve a good livelihood for himself and the future looked promising. He would work for a while and have himself a little stake, enough of a capital with which to build a small cabin on the homestead that he had in mind to preempt. He enjoyed the hard ranch work, the herding of the cattle, though monotonous at times, gave him time for introspection and thought.

He discovered depths of personality in himself that he had been unaware of up to now. In his long and lonely hours, as he rode his pony and kept the herd from straying, he came to truly appreciate the vastness and scope of this new frontier. He grew to love the sunrises and sunsets, the sight of a soaring eagle and the splendid catapult of its unerring dive, the sight of an occasional antelope, the cheekiness of the bright eyed and bushy tailed striped brown and white squirrel. Jorgen came to know, as never before, a closeness and empathy for all the wild creatures. Later on in life, as he found it necessary to hunt to supply food for the family table, he never killed for mere sport. He had too much respect for life to ever indulge in the wanton destruction of it.

Jorgen had been warned not to drink from any unused well or waterhole. On one of his rounds he felt very thirsty, in spite of being warned, he drank from a waterhole, the water looked clear and clean. Much to his sorrow he was to bitterly regret that nearly fatal drink.

The very next day from the time that he had quenched his thirst at the waterhole, he developed a fast rising fever and his head ached. He took to his bed with the chills, although his whole body was wet and clammy with perspiration and his mind started to wander with delirium. The name of his illness was typhoid, an infectious fever, the doctor that had been called in recommended that Jorgen be sent to an isolation ward in a hospital. Jorgen was very sick for a few days, of which he remembered little or nothing.

The crisis passed and one day he opened his eyes, rational again. He was surprised to find himself in a hospital bed and a nursing sister sitting by his bedside. The sister smiled at him and inquired of him how he was feeling. He felt very weak and emaciated but he was grateful to be alive.

It was to be awhile before he was to be fully recovered from his siege and in the meantime he became quite friendly with a girl who had at one time served in a Catholic convent. This girl, Iris, told Jorgen that she had entered the convent for the purpose of taking the vows to become a Catholic nun. It had been her unfortunate experience to have seen and heard of things, secret and sordid as they were and certainly not in harmony with the teachings of the Christ that the teachers, priests and lay people claimed to represent. Iris was very disillusioned with the perfidy, she determined to make her escape from the convent at her first opportunity, it wasn't going to be easy. Iris was afraid, as she was aware that her enemies would take her life, rather than risk that she would reveal her secrets to the outside world.

Iris felt that she had met a confidant in Jorgen and the two became firm friends, there was no thought of a closer relationship. Iris was a few years Jorgen's senior and she was an attractive and intelligent young woman. The two friends had many interesting conversations together, they shared much of the same views on religion, both were skeptical of dogma, as held out by the churches, both were to an extent free thinkers, rebels from the mores of the society of that era.

A few years later on, Iris was to become a prominent figure in the women's liberation movement and it was through her valiant struggles, together with many women of her kind, that women gained full constitutional rights to exercise their votes in political matters. The vote was granted to women in 1919 - 1920.

In the meantime, as Jorgen was not fully recovered from his illness, he had to rest for several periods of his day, so he decided to enroll in a high school class for newly come immigrants. He readily learned

the rudiments of correct English, reading, writing and spelling. He was an eager student and soon assimilated what he had been taught, at the same time he acquired more confidence in himself.

The extra education was also of benefit to him, in that it gave him association and closer contact with other young people, who were eager to improve themselves and their way of life. Most of them would in time become American citizens, although Jorgen was to become a citizen of Canada - that was still in the future.

Jorgen was by this time, well enough to do the lighter chores around the ranch, at least his work supplied him with enough, to pay for his board and room and also a small wage. He had free time in which to explore some of the country side.

The Sunday afternoons were times when Jorgen and Holger would get together and they would ride out to visit the neighboring ranches. They enjoyed the company of other young people and they were soon included in their picnics and baseball games. Holger played a good baseball game, though Jorgen took the part of a spectator, as his weak arm was something of an impediment. This weak arm was the result of a birth injury.

There was also the swimming hole, where the young men used to disport themselves on a sunny Sunday afternoon. There was a good deal of splashing and horseplay involved, a letting down of restraint, as a boisterous good time was enjoyed by all of the participants. Jorgen tried valiantly to swim but no matter how hard that he tried, he couldn't make it. However, not to be outdone and left out of the fun, he got himself a short, light log and with the aid of this, used as ballast, he was able to paddle himself across the river, which was not very deep or swift.

Those were carefree days, life was good and the heavy weight of responsibility of family obligations had as yet, not settled on the shoulders of their easy going youthful years. Had they at that time, had any foreknowledge of the difficult years that lay ahead of them, they might well have been dismayed.

One Sunday evening, Jorgen and Holger had been invited to supper at the home of mutual friends. Also there, as a guest, was a girl of about eighteen or so, to whom Jorgen was introduced. Her name was Edna and she would have been very pretty except for one defect, her eyes were hopelessly crossed. It gave Jorgen a queer sensation, not knowing where her eyes were directed, at him or elsewhere. Edna was not a new acquaintance to Holger and Jorgen could see that she was quite strongly attracted to his friend, which she showed by an arch manner and a shy smile whenever Holger was near her. Holger did not respond to her devotion except by being friendly and pleasant to her.

When the day came that Holger told her quite frankly, that he wasn't prepared to make a commitment of a serious nature and one for which she had no doubt earnestly hoped for, she was quite heartbroken. In her distress she turned to Jorgen and she asked him, if they too could be really good friends. Jorgen had a compassionate heart for the young girl, even though he had no desire or inclination to become romantically involved with her. He answered her with - "We have always been good friends, little Edna". It was perhaps not the answer that little Edna had hoped for but she had to console herself with having Jorgen's friendship. The disappointments of youth are soon forgotten. Edna was unaware that she was a consumptive and that the strain of the disease, inherent in her family, of which it had already taken a heavy toll - soon the bell was to toll for little Edna as she was laid to rest beside her forebears.

Jorgen had been in America for three years and he had been able to save a little money. His thoughts were often with the members of his family, his parents and his sisters. He yearned to see his native land once more, the old familiar places where he had spent his youth and childhood. Time and distance often seem to give an aura to persons and places, an undefinable something, the tissue from which dreams and fantasies are woven, a web, fragile, yet intricate but deceptively strong to hold.

These filial ties that bind one generation to another, a feeling of

continuity that gives an individual a sense of belonging in and to a family, yet being in himself an entity, complete yet separate, with roots that go deep, and even as a tree, if it gets cut down, it will even sprout again, and its own twig will not cease to be. So it was to be, with many emigrants who wrenched up their roots from their native soil and planted them again in the fertile soil of the new land, and the twig that sprouted from that selfsame root, was to flourish and bloom and reproduce, a benediction on the land. America, oh land of hope and promise!

Jorgen wrote to his parents, that he was coming home for a visit, that he was eager to see them, he was looking forward to telling them of his many and varied experiences in the three years that he had been in America. He bade his friend Holger and the Hansens goodbye, with the assurance that he would return in six months to a year. His friends wished Jorgen “good luck” and a safe journey, together with many greetings that he was to relay to friends and relations of theirs.

It took Jorgen three weeks to complete his homecoming journey. So many things looked different to him from the time that he had left his home three years previously, the fields and houses looked smaller, his parents looked older and some of the young people that he had known, had married or moved away. His own horizons had broadened too.

His folks welcomed him warmly and he renewed the old familiar ties with his sisters and his nephews and nieces. They were all very interested in hearing of Jorgen’s experiences and they asked endless questions on what America was like and they wanted to know if it was really as wonderful as the colorful travel brochures pictured. Jorgen represented to them travel and adventure, a style of life quite different from their own uneventful and routine lives, almost prescribed in its monotony.

Jorgen was at that time twenty-six years of age, a young man, who thought that he knew what he wanted from life, freedom to express his ideas, a chance to make his own way up the ladder of success,

without being hampered by social or cultural restrictions, to prove his worth as an individual - only in America was this possible. This was the conclusion that Jorgen had come to after eight months and he was determined to return to America. It was shortly after he had come to this decision, that something took place, that was to change his course of action and have a vital influence on his future.

His family were assembled together for Jorgen's uncle's funeral and for the first time in Jorgen's life, he really noticed his young cousin Margrethe. She was seventeen years old, small and slender with a handspan waistline. Her skin was fair as the first white anemones that bloom in the early spring and her hair was a crown of burnished copper.

Jorgen approached her, in order to offer his condolences, she looked up at him, out of misty, tear wet eyes, grey as a pearly summer morning. Jorgen gently took her hand in his own and as he looked at his sweet young cousin, he felt a tenderness, an emotion new to him, well up in his heart. To him, that day, she seemed the epitome of chastity and purity.

Jorgen was very strongly attracted to his cousin and for him, it was love at first sight and he very much desired to know her better. In the days that followed, the two of them would go walking together, while he told her of his plans for the future, she listened dreamingly, she was slowly falling in love with Jorgen. For her, it was a first love, everything was shining new, a first idyllic romance, an experience that comes but once in a lifetime. The days of courtship are sweet, the exploration of the beloved's personality, the shared hopes and dreams for the future, the willingness to make the commitment that would join their lives together and make them one.

Jorgen knew, without a doubt, that he desired, above all things, Margrethe for his wife, he loved her dearly and she returned his love.

He told her of his plan to return to America for another two years, he asked her to wait for him and when he returned in two years time,

they would plan to marry. She was very young, almost a child, she had led a very sheltered life as a pampered and only daughter, she had one brother and two half sisters - much older than she was. Jorgen thought the two years would mature her and in the meantime she could concentrate on learning some of the arts of homemaking and all of the attendant duties that a good wife should know. Margrethe was very proficient with her needlework and her embroidery was of the finest. It adorned her inner and outer clothing.

The time for Jorgen's departure drew near and the two young people said their fervent goodbyes, they promised one another to write often, Jorgen assured his darling, that the two years would soon pass and when he returned they would be married. He bid his parents and his sisters and friends goodbye.

The year was 1910 and this was to be the third time that Jorgen crossed the Atlantic, he would return to be married in 1912. There was to be an interlude of from six to seven years from the time that he and Margrethe were married in May of 1912 - World War I intervened, to when he once again set foot on American soil.

These events were still to be in the future and Jorgen's heart beat with eager anticipation as his thoughts turned to eventually providing a home for his bride and their prospective family. He felt that this new land held out opportunities for a man and his family, that he could never hope to realize if he stayed in Denmark, his was the free and undaunted spirit of the pioneer.

As Jorgen, once again, for the second time, approached New York harbor and again he gazed on that symbol of liberty, with an awe, an admiration, not a little unmixed with pride. He felt a kinship with the people of this great land, a land wherein he felt that he could firmly put down his roots, a pleasant land that would give him and his children, his children's children, and all of the generations yet to come, the opportunity to grow, to mature, to expand.

Here, a man could, with a modest effort, set himself a goal, apply

himself to its fulfillment, and if he so desired, rise to the very top - a dream to sustain any man! America offered independence to the many emigrants who had left Europe, fleeing from the oppressive rulership of church and state, the tyranny of the ones who seized power and dictated to and controlled the masses of the common people. They waged bloody wars, one country against another and the young men were conscripted into the army.

Some of the sons of these refugees from oppression and poverty, were to become powerful industrialists and financiers, builders and politicians, one was to rise to be the president of the United States.

Once again, he travelled westward - ever westward, he had a twenty four hour layover in Chicago. He now had a fair grasp of the English, this gave him the confidence to venture out on his own. Remembering his and Holger's former experience, he avoided the side streets and he chose the main thoroughfare, wide and crowded. He observed that the Americans were more brisk and busy than the Europeans, there was little if any loitering, everyone seemed bent on one errand or another. The constant clang of the trolley cars, as they stopped to load or unload passengers, was everywhere. There were many horse drawn vehicles, broughams, drawing finely dressed ladies and gentlemen, there could also be seen the odd horseless carriage, Henry Ford's first automobile.

On every street corner was a policeman, directing the traffic, by means of his shrill whistle and outstretched arm, his eternal vigilance was a very necessary adjunct, even so, there could be quite a snarl up of traffic at times and accidents were common.

Jorgen had decided to buy Margrethe a small gift. He sought out a small modest looking jewelery shop and as he entered, his eyes fell on a small swirl of gold, set with a small diamond in the center. He thought of how lovely the pin would look at the throat of his sweetheart's dress. He inquired of the price, found it well within his means and bought it. This was his first gift to her, sometime later on, he sent her a ring to mark their engagement and also a gold watch

and chain. Jorgen was a romantic at heart, he had set his Margrethe on a pedestal, in his heart he compared her to the virtuous woman valued more highly than rubies, mentioned in Proverbs “In her the heart of her husband has put trust, she has rewarded him with good, and not bad, all the days of her life. A capable wife is a crown to her husband.” In after years, so Margrethe proved herself and she was to become the mother to fourteen children. Bitter-sweet the march of time - “de Profundus” - out of the depths!

Jorgen was glad to leave the city, he knew that urban living had no appeal for him. He enjoyed the feeling of space and of uncrowded ways, the aloneness that gave him the freedom to study and appreciate the world around him, as he pleased, for he was a naturalist at heart. His whole being yearned towards the land, to own his own plot, to till it, to make it produce a fair harvest. He thought of himself in the Biblical sense, to be a tiller of the soil and a keeper of the herds. He hoped, that within the next two years, to find himself a suitable piece of land, on which he could eventually build himself a small house and establish a home.

Most of the good arable land, in the State of Washington had been appropriated and what was left was mostly sage brush and sandy country, some of which, would in the future be made to produce prolifically, but only through channels of irrigation.

It was here, that thirty some years later, in 1942, that the Grand Coulee Dam was built by the Bureau of Reclamation of the United States Department of the Interior. Ultimately, the water impounded by the Grand Coulee Dam would irrigate nearly a million and a quarter acres of land, besides furnishing about a million, nine hundred thousand kilowatts of power. It was to open up many and varied projects.

Jorgen, on his return to Washington, was warmly greeted by his friend Holger and the Hansen family. It was shortly after this, that he was involved in a little deal in which he gained nothing. The law of the State was such, that a person could preempt on a homestead only once. Jorgen’s friend Holger, had taken out a homestead and so he

wasn't eligible to claim on a second homestead, a piece of land which he desired and it was adjoining his land. The two friends made a deal, that Jorgen would take out the title in his own name and in turn, give Holger title, legal enough, though of no monetary value to Jorgen.

By dint of hard work and the careful management of his money, by saving every dollar that he earned, Jorgen was able to save a tidy little sum. Two years had gone by, he thought to return to Denmark, marry Margrethe and bring her to America, where he would build a home for her. He had not yet found the ideal spot in which to build - he would leave it till later on, when he and Margrethe were married.

He arrived home early in the spring of 1912, the young couple made tentative plans for a wedding early in April. They would sail on the Titanic, this was to have been their honeymoon trip. Through a fortunate chain of events, their wedding plans had to be postponed, their aforelaid plans didn't materialize and they were not among the passengers of the doomed ocean liner. The steamship was proclaimed by it's builders as being invincible, the unsinkable one.

It was sunk at sea by collision with an iceberg and of the two thousand, two hundred and twenty-three passengers and crew aboard, eight hundred and twenty-three of the passengers and six hundred and eighty-five of the crew perished. There were about seven hundred people that survived that disaster. It was unlikely that both Jorgen and Margrethe would have been among the survivors, so nearly could the course of their lives have been decided and this history never recorded.

Jorgen and Margrethe were married on the third of May 1912.

It was partly Margrethe's reluctance to leave family and friends so soon after her marriage, partly the threat of the outbreak of war, that delayed Jorgen's departure for America. In the meantime he expected to provide a home for his bride. He bought a small acreage, complete with a small and modest home. He reasoned that he could always get his money's return when the time came for him to sell.

He had by no means given up on his plan to emigrate to America, he would wait the opportune time.

In the meantime he decided to carry on with growing the same kind of crop which the former owner had grown, tobacco. Jorgen had a few reservations about growing this crop, he was not in favor of it's use and at no time in his life did he smoke. However, there was not enough land to accommodate a grain crop, the demand for and the price for tobacco was good, so Jorgen put in his tobacco plants.

The place had a pretty garden and also a few fruit trees, also a small poultry yard where Margrethe could keep a few ducks and chickens and by selling eggs to her friends and neighbors, she was able to put a little money in her savings bank.

Jorgen was able to supplement his income by doing day work for the neighboring landholders, his depleted savings were replaced.

It was the springtime of life for the young couple, they were happy in their modest home. While Jorgen was at work, Margrethe was busily learning the housekeeping tasks of keeping a home, in her leisure time she occupied herself with her needlework, some of which, a cushion, a wall hanging, a table cover, added grace and beauty to their home. She was also working on wee baby clothes for the coming of her first child, Esther, born 1913. In the next six years, three more children were to follow, Carl, born 1914, Ethel, born 1916 and Anne, born 1919. The parents were happy with their small family, life was full.

World War I that had erupted in 1914 and had embroiled most of the European countries in its violence, had not included the Scandinavian countries, they remained neutral for the war's duration. The price of all farm produce, together with that of tobacco escalated and so Jorgen was able to realize a good profit from his crop.

It was about in the year of 1916, that Jorgen made, what was to turn out to be a poor investment. He sold his small holding and bought an elegant home, which was to prove only a facade, much to Jorgen's disillusionment. He soon came to the conclusion that

it was an impractical move, as there was not enough land with the house to yield him a living for his family. He and Margrethe talked the problem over and they agreed on selling the place. In fact, Margrethe was relieved at the prospect, as the house was large, with many rooms, built for entertaining and she had neither the time nor the inclination for entertaining, she was content with caring for her young children. Small Esther, at times followed her mother through the empty, unused and unfurnished rooms that were shut off from the family's living quarters.

The house was sold at the cost price, due to the devaluation of the crown at that time, the total transaction proved somewhat of a loss. Rather than buying a house again, Jorgen who still had his mind set on America, decided to rent temporarily.

It was now the summer of 1918, there was talk of the war coming to an end, it dragged on for another few months till November when the Armistice was signed. In 1919 the League of Nations that in 1946 was to become the United Nations was formulated. The period of uneasy peace that followed the signing of the first treaty, was to last twenty years, till World War II broke out, more horrendous and devastating, that was to end only, by the dropping of the first atomic bombs on the cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

Jorgen and Margrethe had now been married for seven years and after the birth of their fourth child, Anne born in April of 1919, they talked over their prospects for the future. It was agreed on that Jorgen should once more return to America in order to establish a home for himself and his family, when he had accomplished this, he would bring Margrethe and their children over. It was the late spring of the year and he promised to be back before Christmas.

Jorgen once more returned to America, to the State of Washington. It was while he was looking for a prospective home site, that he came into contact with and talked to some settlers who were travelling by wagon train to the Canadian prairies, Alberta to be exact. The men of the company told Jorgen that they had heard that homestead land

was readily available to the claimant, the land was rich and fertile, that there was timber enough to provide material for buildings and fuel for the frigid winters.

There was enough work to be had for the hardy individual, such as that supplied by the construction gangs on the railroad and the lumber mills. A man could make enough of a stake, working at these, to give him a start on his land and with a team of horses, a couple of cows and a few chickens, with perhaps a pig or two, he could make a frugal living for himself and his family. He could grow a good vegetable and berry garden during the warm summer days and so supplement his food supply.

The idea of making a new beginning, in what was still virgin territory, appealed to Jorgen and he decided to investigate his prospects for himself. Through association with friends, he knew of a man by the name of Larsen, who had emigrated from Denmark and he had come to Ponoka, a small town in central Alberta.

Jorgen decided to make Ponoka his destination and while there, he would contact Mister Larsen and ask for his help in finding a suitable place to live and to which he could bring his family.

Jorgen's first impression of Ponoka was reserved, the town seemed huddled together in the shadow of three tall grain elevators and a C.P.R. water tower, which was supported on a many timbered scaffold. The town's few streets were dirt roads, dusty in the summer time and muddy in the spring and late autumn, in the winter they were slushy with snow and ice, as they were ploughed up by the sleds and horseback riders.

The business section of the town was comprised mainly of a bank, a post office, two hotels, two or three stores, a black-smith and harness repair shop, a couple of restaurants and a pool hall. There were three churches, Catholic, Anglican and Lutheran, two schools, grade school and high school. This then, was the hub of the town and around it sprawled the cluster of houses, nearly all built from raw lumber, a

few neat and trim and painted with small and tidy enclosures, the majority were shack like and unpainted with sagging lean to's and warped window frames.

In his mind's eye, Jorgen may well have contrasted the appearance of these raw looking houses to those that he knew so well, the neat rosy brick houses of his native Denmark. He may well have had his reservations at the thought of bringing his Margrethe to this strange new land and such unfamiliar surroundings.

However, he reasoned, nothing ventured, nothing gained, he would contact Mister Larsen, whom he had written to. He met the man Larsen, found him friendly and outspoken and he obligingly offered to help a newcomer to locate a piece of land for himself, as it was, Larsen knew of a piece of property that was for sale at a very reasonable price. The land was close to town and this was important, as Jorgen's children would soon be of school age. Jorgen eagerly accepted Larsen's offer to look at the land, while the two of them were driving there, Larsen told Jorgen that this was largely a Danish settlement and that he would introduce Jorgen to some of his Danish friends. This pleased Jorgen and it was partly this that proved a determining factor in his decision to make this community his home. Had he at that time, known of the severity of the Alberta winters, he might have had a change of heart.

He looked over the quarter section of land of which about half had been cleared and broken and the remainder was in scrub brush and a few small stands of spruce and poplar trees. There was a small three room frame house and a log barn with a straw covered roof, together with a couple of small outbuildings and a log corral. All of this looked quite primitive to Jorgen, he could afford this and he would make improvements. He would extend and improve the house, poor though it was. He would leave himself enough money so that he could buy a team of horses, a milk cow and a few chickens. He would buy or borrow the essential farm implements, such as a walking plow and a harrow, in order to break up some more land. He would also need a wagon of a sort in order to haul his hay and grain, it would also

serve as a rough but simple means of transportation. With all of this in mind, Jorgen made the required down payment on the place. He would make further payments when he came to take possession of the land, which he hoped to be able to do, early the following spring, when he had brought his family over.

With these arrangements made, Jorgen began to think of returning to Denmark, to prepare his family for the big move, which was to greatly change the course of all of their lives. If he and Margrethe could have known at that time what heartbreak and hardship lay ahead of them, they would almost certainly have faltered.

Jorgen was full of enthusiasm in that his plans were at last maturing, he had convinced Margrethe that this move would insure their children of the best opportunity to be forever free from the old social order of class distinction and narrow centuries old traditional dogma. He was full of zeal and fervor for the new beginning but he knew in his heart that life in the new land, might be more difficult for his gentle Margrethe. She had known only the good life, comfortable, pampered and surrounded by loving family and friends. Jorgen consoled her with the promise that they and their family would make a return trip to her homeland in ten years. As it turned out, she never saw her mother or her brother and her two half sisters again.

Early in the year of 1920, trunks were bought and the packing began. It was a nerve wracking task, sorting out what was to be taken and what was to be left behind with friends and family. Clothing and bedding were among the essentials but restrictions had to be made on china and silver, many of these items had been wedding gifts. Jorgen felt badly when he had to restrain his wife from packing these cherished items, although he knew that their future life would have little use for the refinements of culture. The only luxury that Margrethe was allowed to pack was her exquisite embroidery work, it was to provide the only gracious touch of refinement to her simple home, plain and unadorned.

Margrethe often thought longingly of the secure home that she was leaving, of the tender relationships of family and close friends, people

that she had known and associated with all of her lifetime, people whom she loved and trusted and they returned her affection, she would miss them sorely. She knew, deep within her heart, that she might never set foot on her homeland again. In time, her passionate longing for her old home and the people there faded and her many children consoled her for the yearning to see those that had been so near and dear to her heart.

Part II

The fortitude of the pioneer women who left the security and comforts of their homes in order to follow their mates and husbands to unknown lands and unfamiliar surroundings was remarkable. Their endurance and courage was to be long remembered by their posterity, the story of their lives was to be told and retold over the generations - yet unborn.

The women of those early days, were the unsung heroines that helped develop and build the still, raw and rugged untamed wilderness. Theirs was the dauntless spirit and the unfailing loyalty that enabled them to stand shoulder to shoulder with their men - true help mates.

They lived in and brought up their families in sod shanties, roughly constructed log or shiplap siding shacks, usually with two rooms and a cramped loft space, which provided sleeping quarters for the children of the family. The icy winds of winter would blow through the cracks in the walls. The nails were rimed in hoarfrost.

The main room of the house was the kitchen, with it's rough floor and rough grey building paper covered walls, sometimes hung with a couple of pairs of deer antlers and perhaps an almanac, from some patent medicine outfit.

In the center of this room stood the plank table with it's backless benches flanking it on either side, it was on this table and by the light of the coal oil lamp, which stood on the center of the table, that any reading or letter writing was done. Here also, the children of the family gathered to do their homework from school.

Anyone, not seated around the table, or otherwise occupied, usually hugged the kitchen stove, especially so, during the long winter evenings. Any shelf or cupboard space was usually put together from any discarded packing crate, a stand for the water pail and wash basin, which provided for wash ups, completed the furnishing.

There was usually a baby born, a year and a half to two years apart and during a woman's childbearing years, she might give birth to ten

to twelve children or even more - many children died in early infancy. Valiantly, these women endured and stoically they bore their birth pangs, attended only by a neighbor woman, who had perhaps a little experience in child delivery. Doctors were few and far between and at times, a mother, giving birth might die from lack of proper care, leaving a grieving husband and a motherless family. Many widowed men were married two or three times as a result of losing their wives in childbirth.

If there were no complications and all went well, another family member was accepted and welcomed by it's parents. The family of that day - about 1920, usually was made up of from eight to a dozen children - it was a prolific period. Many children died very young, from the complications of measles, scarlet fever and influenza - often pneumonia set in, as an aftermath of the illness and it usually proved fatal.

Margrethe, herself was to bear fourteen children and she suffered four miscarriages, during her forty nine years of marriage. Her sorrows were to start early, she had at that time four children, she was to lose one, her little boy and his father's dearest treasure.

Carl was a delicate child with fine, sensitive features, tender hearted and gentle in all his ways, easily moved to tears. His frail constitution was not able to withstand the hardships encountered aboard ship, being seasick, subjected to drafts along the corridors. The portholes had to be opened at times in order to clear the air from the almost overpowering smell of vomit within the cramped and confined quarters. Margrethe and all four children were sick.

Jorgen was the only member of his family that remained well, he was kept busy waiting on his family, as now little Anne, the one year old baby of the family became ill also. A doctor was brought in for the two sick children, Carl was by this time seriously ill and the doctor diagnosed pneumonia. There was little to be done, besides keeping him warm and free from drafts and sudden changes in temperature. It would be nearly another twenty years before the wonder sulfa

drugs were discovered.

The baby Anne, continued to hold her own but Carl's condition grew steadily worse and he was hot and fevered and talking in delirium. The parents hearts, heavy with dread and fear for their little boy, cried out in anguish at the thought that they might lose their beloved child. Earnestly, they prayed that he might be spared to them.

The voyage that had started out so hopefully, now seemed fraught with sadness and pain. As Margrethe sat with her little ones, her thoughts returned to her homeland and she thought, that perhaps if she had never left it, she would not have had to endure this sense of utter hopelessness and futility. She seemed to have left joy behind forever.

In her despair she seemed to have become alienated, even from her husband. Her grief was compounded - she had given up her home and now perhaps she would have to give up her son - her only son.

Jorgen's courage was being severely tried, he had to keep his emotions in check and try to assume a confident demeanor, while his heart burned within him. In the meantime he went about the business of transferring his family from ship to shore, getting through the customs and entraining for their destination, westward to Ponoka, Alberta. This accomplished, the parents set about making things as comfortable as possible for their sick children.

The two children were too ill to eat and it was a matter of keeping them warm and free from the drafts, caused from the often opened doors at either end of the coach, not an easy thing to do. Jorgen and Margrethe took turns in staying awake and watching their children, through the long dreary nights.

It was on one of these nights, as the mother watched over her children, drearily watching her own sad reflection from the dark pane of glass confronting her and listening to the rasping breath coming from her little boy, that she had, what she felt was a revelation. The dawn was

breaking across the sky and as she looked out and up, she saw a blue lake, with gardens and villas reflected from its depths - the image in the sky was crystal clear and Margrethe watched silently and marvelled at the wondrous sight. Her heart beat heavily within her breast and she wondered if perhaps this indeed could be a portend of things to come, she thought that she had been granted a vision of the heavenly kingdom.

Her heart turned cold and heavy with dread - was this the omen that her child would be taken to that heavenly abode? Later on, as she told her husband of what she had seen, his heart too, beat fast with anxiety, as he tried to comfort his wife in her extremity of travail.

In later years, they were to learn that what Margrethe had seen that early morning was a mirage, a sight not too uncommon around the Great Lakes, by which they were travelling at the time. A mirage appears as an object in the air, suspended and inverted.

The days seemed interminably long as the train pushed its way steadily over the prairies. It was late March and much of the landscape was still under a foot of snow, there seemed to be endless miles of power line poles, the sun shone bright in a cloudless sky of intense blue, that stretched on and on, into infinity itself or so it seemed. To Margrethe, the view seemed bleak, in stark contrast to that of her homeland. The dinginess of the depots and small towns at which the train frequently stopped, only served to emphasize the disparity from the neat, clean little towns which she had known. The rawness of this strange new land depressed her even further.

The two older girls sat quietly during the day, as they watched the passengers come and go. They listlessly ate their sandwiches, they slept restlessly at night, they seemed in some indefinite sense to feel their parents' anxiety. They were ages three and six and Carl was five years of age. The baby, Anne, was eleven months.

The family had been aboard the train for three days and it became apparent to Jorgen that his son was deathly ill.

He decided to stop over in the small city of Moose Jaw and admit Carl to a hospital in that city. He took a hotel room for his family and he and Margrethe took turns watching at the bedside of their beloved child. Two days, the battle for life was waged and the light went out for Carl. The last words that he uttered were - "light the lamp, Mother."

The light also seemed to go out for the grieving parents and sadly they made arrangements to have their child's body carried with them to their destination. Carl would be laid to rest where his family could at least visit his resting place. Oh, bitter, bitter, scalding tears that fell on that small white coffin!

A chapter was closed, life must go on in spite of tears and heartbreak. The father and mother were thankful that the baby, Anne, was improving and able to smile again.

Jorgen did his best to console his pale young wife, tenderly he wiped her tears and persuaded her to lie down and rest, she was exhausted from grief and sleeplessness. His thoughts began to turn to the future, he was nearly destitute as Carl's illness and subsequent care had depleted his small capital. Besides being burdened with sorrow at the loss of his son, he was also very worried about his lack of funds and of how he was going to be able to provide for the needs of his small family. He could not bring himself to confide in Margrethe, as he thought that she had enough to bear and she was not in a position to help him - at least not for the moment.

As it was, the family arrived in Ponoka on a biting cold day, around the first of April - the snow lay three feet deep all around. Jorgen had exactly seventy five dollars in his wallet. Mr. Larsen and a few Danish people were on the station platform to greet and to offer their sympathy to the family. An offer of a place to stay was kindly extended and gratefully accepted by Jorgen and Margrethe. This would carry them over till they found a place to live.

Also funeral arrangements had to be made for the little boy Carl. He had completed his journey in his narrow bed and his dust was to

minge with that of the prairie soil. Over the years, five more members of the family would find a resting place in that same cemetery, a little three year old boy by the name of Peter and Jorgen and Margrethe - also a little girl - a granddaughter and her grandmother's namesake and a grandson, Donald. Peacefully they rest, secure in God's memory until the glorious resurrection morning, when all things shall be made new.

Jorgen's priority now was to look to the needs of his family. He was bitterly disappointed in the fact that the piece of property that he had made a down payment on and with the option of continuing the payments when he took possession, had been sold. Jorgen had no proper legal contract to prove right of ownership - he made the mistake of trusting a man's word. This left Jorgen with no alternative but to find a house to rent and to immediately look for a job in order to support his family.

He and Margrethe found a small frame house with two rooms downstairs, a kitchen and a small living room.

The upstairs, reached by a narrow stairway, had two small bedrooms. Jorgen was able to acquire some second hand furniture at a house sale. He bought the bare necessities, a small cast iron stove, that would serve both for cooking and heat. He was fortunate enough to buy a solid oak table and four matching chairs, also two brass and white iron bedsteads, complete with a pair of not too dilapidated mattresses. The parents slept in the one bed, together with their one year old baby, Anne, the two girls slept in the other one. Margrethe was thankful for the warm down quilts and the bedding that she had brought with her from her homeland. The one touch of elegance was her beautifully hand embroidered pillow cases and sheet borders. She had also brought with her lace curtains. These, she hung up at the narrow windows of her new home. Together with a couple of oil paintings, minus frames, she was able to provide a simple but homelike atmosphere for her husband and children.

Jorgen brought home groceries, the bare essentials, a bag of flour for

making bread, some sugar, a pound of coffee and a dozen eggs, some ground meat and a few potatoes. A pound of butter was a luxury at a dollar and twenty cents, eggs were the same price a dozen and a bushel of potatoes was five dollars. The cost of living, due to inflation, was very high. This was 1920 and the economy of the country had as yet not leveled off as a result of the war. These were inflated prices and it wasn't till nine years later that the pendulum was to swing to the other extreme and the whole international economy was to collapse and a countrywide depression was to be the result.

On entry to Canada, Jorgen had exchanged his Danish crowns for Canadian dollars and the rate of exchange was very high, seven crowns to the dollar. He was unfortunate in this transaction as only two years later, the exchange dropped to three crowns to the dollar.

Jorgen, now having his family housed, turned his attention to finding work for himself. He was advised that he should inquire about working on the section gang of the railroad. The thought of this job was not exactly appealing to Jorgen but he must have an income and soon. He applied for the job and got it, his wages were three dollars a day and he was to work six days a week. It was back breaking work, blistering hot during the summer months, with no escape from sun and torrential rains, bitterly cold through the long winter months, fully exposed as the men were to the elements, icy winds that nipped at toes and fingers, also earlobes. At times, when visibility would be almost nil, due to a blizzard blowing, the work could be very hazardous and especially if the men were on the pushcart. In fact, the boss did lose his life one day, while he was trying to lift the pushcart off the railroad track in the face of an oncoming freight train.

This particular episode really shocked Jorgen and he made up his mind to stay with the railroad just long enough in order to save up the money to be able to make a down payment on a piece of land. As it turned out, he worked on the section gang for three years and by careful saving and buying only the bare essentials, he and Margrethe did save one thousand dollars, enough to make a start on. For one summer the small family lived in a tent and so saved on the rent for

a few months.

It was an experience quite novel to Margrethe and it certainly did cut down on housekeeping chores, although she did have to carry water by the buckets from a stock yard, a good distance away. She didn't mind that, as she was young and healthy.

Margrethe kept busy and did her share of saving by the sewing of all of their clothing, with the exception of Jorgen's overalls. She owned a little hand-turned sewing machine, which served her faithfully for many years. Had she been able to count in dollars the amount that she saved by making over the clothes that people gave her, she would have earned a goodly sum.

Had she known of the difficult years to come, she might have lost her courage and given up in despair, for in her heart she still grieved for the child that she had lost and the aching void remained, even though over the years to come, she was to bear another ten children. She was not a strong woman and the many births took a heavy toll on her health.

In the meantime, their eldest child, Esther, had started to school. She was a shy little girl and, dressed as she was, in very practical clothes made over from hand-me-downs, heavy black ribbed stockings, and sturdy black laced-up boots, she didn't make the most favorable impression. Even at the tender age of seven, she felt quite keenly the distinction between herself and the other little girls in their black patent slippers and with big satin bows in their curled hair. To add to the child's feeling of belittlement, there was also the barrier of language, the English tongue was comparatively new to her, as she had not had much association with other children of her age, and the Danish language was being spoken at home.

In a short time, Esther was to become as fluent as any of her classmates, but the scars left from discrimination are cruel and tend to make a child withdraw into himself. Children are not naturally prejudiced, but their attitudes are usually a reflection of their parents' views.

Esther, as being the eldest child in the family, bore the responsibility of being the errand and messenger carrier. Her mother would send her to the grocery store to purchase a pound of butter or perhaps some carrots or lemons. Esther usually managed to make herself understood by pointing to the article desired.

It was the first Christmas for the little family in their new home, and there were some small gifts to be delivered to some Danish friends who had shown much kindness to the new family. Little Esther was sent to deliver these tokens. She had three blocks to walk, and the night was bitterly cold. She had no mittens on her hands, her mother had not realized how cold an Alberta winter could be. As a result, the child returned home, after completing her errand, with frostbitten fingers and tears streaming down her woe begone face. Her father hurriedly rubbed the little icy hands with snow, this was supposed to take the frost out of the fingers and relieve the tingling. He did the best that he knew how, though it might have proven more effective if he had used warm water in a bowl and had the child plunge her hands in that.

There are many things that only experience teaches, and one of the many things that were still to be learned was the harshness of the long Alberta winters, with its blizzards and wind chills that could drop within a few hours from zero to fifty below.

Jorgen had one hobby in which he might indulge himself on a Sunday afternoon, that of target shooting. He liked his high-powered rifle, and as he had no occasion to hunt, he would go to the nearby lot that contained a few scrubby poplars and some spruce and undergrowth, in order to practice his sport. This continued for a few weekends, till he was notified by the town law enforcement that he was out of bounds and he would have to stop, there was always the danger of an accident.

The restricted lifestyle of a small town did not suit Jorgen, and neither he nor Margrethe took any interest in civic affairs nor the social life of the community. They still felt like strangers in an alien

land. Margrethe especially often longed for her homeland and her family there.

They had been in Canada for a year and a half when another child was born to them, a little boy whom they named Carl, in memory of the son that they had lost and still so deeply grieved for. Time heals all wounds, but the scars remain.

With her baby boy and her husband and her three little girls to care for, Margrethe kept busy, cleaning, cooking, sewing the family's clothing, most of it cut down and made over from passed down and outdated clothing that people gave her. Margrethe was also very deft with her knitting needles, and she knit Jorgen's and her children's socks and mittens. Her busy fingers were never idle, and in the summertime, she loved to take her children with her to a wooded spot, where she could perhaps pick a few strawberries or raspberries, whichever the case might be. She would bring home a syrup pail full of berries, a real treat for her family.

In the meantime, Jorgen, working on the section gang, was still saving every possible dollar toward the purchase of a quarter section of farmland. He was at that time about forty years of age, and he felt that it was high time that he got established at something permanent and had a home of his own.

One day, while he was at work, he noticed that he was being watched and furtively followed by a little stray looking white and black collie type of dog. Jorgen had always had a special liking for dogs and horses. He offered the timid animal a piece of his sandwich, the dog was hungry and he accepted eagerly and his brown eyes shone with gratitude. Jorgen had pity for the abandoned animal and he made up his mind to take it home with him at quitting time, the family could use a pet and he wouldn't cost much to feed. Margrethe and the children welcomed "Pal" as Jorgen had decided to call him. Pal remained a faithful friend and companion to Jorgen until the day of his unfortunate death, he was run over by a car. The poor injured dog dragged his broken and bleeding body home, once there, he

retreated to the farthest out corner under his absent master's bed. Although Margrethe and the girls tried to coax Pal to come out from his cover, the dog only whined and refused. It was not until evening and Jorgen's return from work, hearing his dearly loved master's voice, that Pal crawled agonizingly from under his shelter, gave one long pitiful whine and a very weak wag of his tail, and dropped dead at Jorgen's feet.

It was the spring of 1923, for three years Jorgen had worked on the section gang, a long hard haul, through the blistering heat of summer and the icy blasts of winter. From the three dollars a day that he made in wages and working a six day work week, he had managed to save one thousand dollars, enough to make a down payment on a quarter section of land. He began to look around to see what might be available and in the meantime he heard of a quarter section, situated twenty four miles northwest of Ponoka, on it was a frame house and a log barn. It was a long ways to town and the roads, in places, were mere trails, almost impassable in a rainy season and it was not uncommon to mire down in some slough or muskeg.

In some sloughs, attempts had been made to build corduroy roads, built from logs or poles laid cross-wise. These roads were not very satisfactory, to the say the least. A trip into town by wagon and team, or in the winter time by sleigh and team, took six hours going and equally long on the return trip, an arduous journey for man and beast. In the lean years, in the hungry thirties, there was many a time, when Jorgen and one or two of his family drove the fifty mile round trip, without the comfort of a meal in one of the three or four local restaurants. A package of home packed sandwiches appeased their hunger, together with a syrup can of cold coffee. If the trip was in the winter time, the weather might be ten to twenty below zero and it would be necessary for driver and passengers to get out of the sleigh and walk along side, in order to keep from freezing. The rigors of an Alberta winter required a good deal of stamina and hardihood from those that were brave enough to battle its many vagaries.

The one big advantage the farm had, was that it was within a mile's

distance of the district school, a little one room frame building. This consideration was of prime importance to Jorgen and Margrethe and they required that their children's school be within walking distance. The parents put a great deal of emphasis on their children's education. Country schools were few and far between and some children had to walk, ride or drive four to five miles in order to attend school, in spite of these conditions there was not much absenteeism.

Jorgen bought the farm in 1923, there was much hard work ahead of him. There were only fifteen to twenty acres broken and cleared of brush and some poplar and spruce, the hundred and forty acres consisted of brush, small timber and slough land.

It was back breaking work chopping brush and then piling it in a stack, ready to burn at an opportune day. Some of the tree stumps, had to be pulled out of the ground, by being circled with a stout logging chain, this in turn, was attached to a double tree that connected with the harness of a team of horses. After the tree stumps and brush had been burnt, then, came the breaking up of the tough prairie sod. This was done by means of a one share plow and it was grueling labor to keep the team plowing a straight furrow and at the same time keeping the share from heaving out of the soil, as it would strike at times, a rock or a buried root. Truly, by the sweat of his brow, Jorgen earned his daily bread. The conditions under which he worked were primitive, had he had a little more money, he could have bought bigger and better equipment, the tractor was just coming in to its own and by its use, Jorgen could have cultivated in one day, that which took him a week or more to do.

Life was not all drudgery, there were the quiet Sunday afternoons, Jorgen and his family observed the Sabbath faithfully, it was a day set apart, a day to rest and worship. Jorgen's religious principles were so strongly entrenched, from the time of his youth, that no unnecessary work was to be done on Sundays, only the chores, such as feeding the animals and milking the cows. The older children might be allowed to visit a school friend, providing that they did not attend the local ball game. Such a life may sound dull and colorless, it was not - in the

summer times the youngsters would join together for a splash in the river, in the winter times, there would be sleighing on the river hills.

The neighbourhood farmers would work every day of the week through the spring, plowing, harrowing and seeding - also at harvest time they would be busy. There was usually one farmer, who was the owner of a threshing machine, which was operated on a communal system. The threshing crew made up of the farmers in that particular area or township, they numbered about twelve to fourteen men, each man drove his own team and rig. Each man loaded his rig with bundles of grain and as he, together with the rest of the crew, formed a line and as such, they drew up in rotation by the side of the threshing machine and so they unloaded their bundles into the yawning maw of the machine, with it's whirling teeth of the cylinders. The separator let out a cloud of dust and the golden chaff of straw that separated from the ripe kernels of grain, formed a stack that steadily grew outwards and upwards. All the while, the grain poured from a funnel and into a wagon box, as soon as there was a full load, it was hauled away and dumped into a granary.

Another wagon drove up and took its place and so it continued until the job was complete. When one farmer's threshing was done, the threshing rig moved on to the next place in line and so the men worked early and late. It was at times, a real race to beat the elements, an early fall of snow could stop the threshers and the grain stocks might be left standing in the fields, till the next spring. By that time the field mice would have left the sheaves, empty of kernels.

The threshers worked very hard, they had good healthy appetites and they eagerly awaited, with real anticipation, the hearty meals that the farm women prepared and cooked for them. The women vied for the name of being the best cook in the countryside, they set their tables with the choicest of their homegrown products, the plumpest of their poultry, prime ham and beef, succulent vegetables from their gardens, home baked bread and buns, pickles, relishes and salads. To top a splendid meal there were the different pies, custard, apple, cherry, chocolate, lemon and pumpkin, topped with rich gobs of

whipped cream. Truly a meal fit for a king! In addition there was the afternoon lunch, sandwiches, cake and cookies, together with gallons of coffee. The lunch was usually carried out in the field to the men.

Jorgen broke up a few acres of land every year, in addition to the acres he already had under cultivation. During the summer months of July and August, he was busy cutting the grass, which grew tall in the slough lands. This provided enough hay to feed the few cattle and the team of horses through the winter time. This was the time of the mid twenties and the market price for farm produce was fairly good, a cow sold for one hundred dollars, the price for cream and eggs was enough to pay for the groceries.

Besides this, Margrethe managed to grow a fair sized vegetable garden, she picked the saskatoons and raspberries that grew so liberally by the way side and in any abandoned building lot. In the autumn there were the patches of deep blue, sweet and juicy blueberries to be picked. A dish of these, smothered in cream and sugar, was a most delicious treat and much enjoyed by the family. On a cold winter's night, it was like sampling the lingering sweetness of summer, to open a jar of ruby red raspberries and enjoy their goodness.

Margrethe baked her own bread, churned her own butter and preserved her own meat. Once in awhile she would bake doughnuts or cinnamon buns for her family. What a lovely surprise it was, for the children coming home from school, to find the kitchen table laden with these goodies, truly they were ambrosia to the taste.

Once a week there was the family wash - no small chore! Margrethe spent hours, bending over an iron and zinc wash tub full of hot soapy water, she rubbed the clothes up and down on a corrugated steel board, commonly known as the wash board. Before the water for the wash could be heated on a boiler on the top of the stove, it first had to be carried, two buckets at a time, from an open well, from where the water was hauled up, hand over fist, from the depths of the well. It was quite a distance between the well and the house, so carrying the two pails full of water was quite a tiring job in itself. The finished

wash was hung out on a rail fence to dry. In the winter time, the garments froze stiff as a board and they assumed all kinds of fantastic shapes. It took a real effort to pry them free from their icy moorings.

Margrethe even made her own laundry soap out of animal fat and lye. It did a thorough enough job on the laundry but it was hard on the skin of her hands. Her knees were at times trembling with fatigue. She did not have the physical stamina to endure the seemingly unending work and the many pregnancies - some of them, only fifteen months between.

She, who had not so long ago, been slim and youthful was aging prematurely. Her body thickened during her pregnancies, her legs, ankles and feet swelled with water retention. Her skin, which had been soft and white, turned sallow because of an unbalanced diet - not having any fresh fruit or vegetables during the long winter months. There were times, when even the potatoes and carrots that were stored in the earthen cellar, under the kitchen floor, froze. The diet then consisted of, cooked beans, coarse homemade whole wheat bread and some wild meat, deer or prairie chicken. An apple at Christmas time was considered a real luxury.

Margrethe also had the chore of milking the cows, usually four or five. One day, when Jorgen had gone to town, expecting to be gone overnight, she had a very frightening experience. She had been in the barn, milking the cows and when she had finished the job, and returned to her house, she discovered her little boy to be missing. It was dusk and it would soon be dark and where was Carl?

Imagine her dismay and dread, at the thought of her sixteen month old baby being lost and alone.

Fortunately he was warmly dressed, in heavy wool overalls and sweater, he had wool socks and cloth slippers on his feet but he wore no toque on his head. His blonde hair was fairly long and thick. It was the spring of the year, late April and the nights could still be bitterly cold, this particular night was not quite so cold, as the sky

was completely overcast with clouds and no moon or star shone in the sky.

The mother told her two little girls, Ethel and Anne to get themselves something to eat and in case that she wasn't back shortly, they were to go to bed. She lit her lantern and taking her eldest child, Esther, by her hand, she set out in search of her strayed child. Mother and daughter stayed together as they followed the narrow and winding trails or stumbled through the adjoining bush. With a prayer in her heart, the mother thought of the waterholes, that she knew had been dug in various locations on the land. The little girl, Esther, wondered why her mother wanted her to accompany her, they could not search separately as there was only the one lantern. When Esther was older, she came to know how very much her mother needed the comfort and support that only another human being could provide.

The hours dragged wearily by, it was midnight, the night was pitch black, without the light from the lantern that the mother carried, the two of them could only see a very few feet ahead of them. The mother grew more and more anxious and afraid. Finally, in desperation, she decided to send Esther to the neighbors to ask for help. There was a mile to go, the child was afraid but she made no complaint, as she set out on her mission.

She stumbled on and off the road in the darkness, she saw a pale object at a little distance, it moved across the field - later on, she was told that it was a horse. Tense with fright and tired, she approached the neighbors house, she knocked on the door and after that which seemed an interminable time, the door was opened by the head of the family - very surprised looking. It was two o'clock in the morning.

The child blurted out her errand and the request for help. She was assured of aid and at the first break of dawn, all of the neighbors had been alerted and they all joined in the search for Carl. By daylight it was much easier searching and in half an hour the last child was found and restored to his mother's arms. The little boy was no worse for his ordeal, he seemed to have slept soundly, underneath the very

same log, as his exhausted mother had sat and rested on, the night before.

By this time, word of his family's plight had reached Jorgen. He hurriedly set out for home, he was thankful to find his family intact and he felt deep appreciation for the neighborly help, so quickly and willingly extended. He was to get to know a good deal of that spirit of helpfulness in the time to come.

Besides caring for her family and their needs, Margrethe was prevailed upon to board and room the teacher, reluctantly she agreed to this. The house hardly provided room for an extra person as there were only two rooms, a kitchen and a bedroom downstairs and the upstairs was undivided by any partitions or walls.

The house was heated by a wood burning iron heater, the stove pipes rose from the heater, went up through the upstairs floor and from there on the pipes extended up through the shingled roof. This was a real fire trap, many a time, the stove pipes got overheated from a briskly burning fire, turned red hot and the sparks of fire, threatened to burn the roof, house and all of its contents. It was many a winter's night, that Jorgen sat up most of the night, in order to fire the heater and guard against a catastrophe.

With the advent of the teacher, a room had to be provided for her, in order that she might have her privacy. One end of the loft was boarded off, papered and curtained and furnished with a white and brass bedstead, a rocking chair and a small table, complete with a coal oil lamp. The bed had comfortable down pillows and a down comforter. This bedding was one of the few luxuries, that Margrethe had brought with her from her homeland.

The teacher arrived, driven out from town by horse and buggy, courtesy of one of the neighbors. She was small and slight and near middle age. Her hair was severely drawn back from her small face and knotted in a tight bun at the back of her head. Her clothing suited the mode of a former day, her skirts reached her ankles and they

were drab in color, mostly dull greys and browns. Her shoes were no nonsense laced up boots and she wore aprons over her voluminous skirts. There was only one soft looking thing about her - her eyes, behind the steel rimmed spectacles, they looked half frightened, half shy. Her slight air of aggressiveness was to her a shield, a protection with which to ward off the many barbs that surrounded her.

The teacher, like Caesar's wife, had to be above reproach. Her conduct was closely observed and commented on by the community as a whole whether she accepted any dates from the single men, if she joined the community activities or attended the church services that were held in the school house bi-weekly and presided over by an itinerant preacher.

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The teacher, her name was Ida, she and Margrethe came to be quite good friends. Both were lonely for woman companionship and so they helped one another, Ida taught Margrethe to know the English language better and in her turn, Margrethe gave the lonely spinster a sense of comfort by including her as one of the family. When a baby girl was born to Margrethe in late November, Ida suggested that they name her Daisy and Daisy she became.

Now Jorgen and Margrethe had five children to provide and care for and only a limited income to cover their needs. Christmas was coming close, the glittering toy displays were far off in town - which perhaps was just as well under the circumstances. No little girl to stand in front of a shop window to wistfully gaze at the dolls, complete with real hair wigs and with eyes of blue or brown that could open and shut, depending on whether they were stood up or laid down. The hope of being able to possess one of these beauties was only a dream.

However, the mother compensated for the lack of money by making stuffed cloth dolls, embroidering mouth, nose and eyes on the faces. From skeins of wool, she sewed on the hair and she sewed the dolls a complete wardrobe, altogether, when these dolls were finished, they were very huggable dolls.

Ida named one of them after an Eskimo, that she had read about “Ada Blackjack”. Ethel dearly loved her Ada Blackjack and even when years later, she received a gorgeous “Eaton’s Beauty” doll for Christmas, the doll was never doted on, as the simple ragdoll had been. The father had carved out of a piece of wood, a beautiful little horse for Carl and he had also made a wooden cradle for the new baby, Daisy. Little Anne was happy with her own Raggedy Ann baby and Esther had worn her new hand knitted sweater.

Jorgen had gone out in the woods in order to find a Christmas tree, it had to be just right in symmetry and just seven feet in height. Jorgen was still a perfectionist at heart, as he trudged through the pristine white snow, he looked at and cherished his small kingdom and he exulted in his independence. His spirit soared at the thought of the opportunities that yet lay ahead of him. His thoughts reverted to the time of his childhood, when he, together with his father had come on the same errand, that of finding and cutting a Christmas tree. Jorgen in his mind, contrasted his father’s position with that of his own. His father had had to get permission from the lord of the manor, who in his own condescending way, told them where they could cut and what size the tree could be. His father had never in his lifetime, owned any land, beyond that which his humble home was built on. For all of his life he had been subservient to his betters and he didn’t hope to rise above that, caught as he was, in a culture of age old class distinction.

In this new land, Jorgen felt and knew himself to be the equal of his fellowman, if he so desired. The opportunities were there and he only had to reach out and grasp them. He had no ambition to be wealthy but only that he and his might be comfortable and be able to live in peace and security, He advocated the farmers union and this was at a time when any kind of workers union was unpopular, he recognized

that there was strength in unity of purpose.

The farmer should be able to make a fair living for himself, by selling his produce at an equitable price and not to be at the mercy of the vagaries of the stock market, after all, wheat is a food to feed the hungry not a commodity to be gambled with. So thought and reasoned Jorgen.

Jorgen augmented his living, by trapping. There was a little muskeg lake on his farm, wherein the muskrats built their domed shaped houses. In the wintertime, Jorgen set his traps beside the houses, the animals were easily taken. Their hides at that time were worth two to three dollars a hide. The fur dealer made a very good margin of profit on these skins, as much as one hundred percent. At one time, rabbit skins sold for eight cents a skin. The rabbits were abounding by the thousands and they scarcely seemed wild, so they were easily killed. Margrethe was an expert at skinning these, she could skin a rabbit in five minutes. It must have been the year when there was a population explosion among the rabbits, because they were never again so prolific.

The coyotes kept their number down and eventually there was only an occasional rabbit seen.

Jorgen might be lucky enough to bag a coyote skin or two, during the winter. These were worth from fifteen to twenty dollars each, depending on the color and quality of the skin.

There was also the family larder to be provided for, this was taken care of by the addition of deer, partridge and prairie chicken. A pig or two provided bacon and an odd pork roast. Margrethe also made head cheese from the pig and she rendered her own lard. Nothing went to waste.

Jorgen found his neighbors helpful and friendly, they could be depended on in times of real need, such as sickness or a death in the family. They were quick to show their sympathy and they assumed

responsibility for any errands to be relayed or any jobs to be done around the place. In case of a house fire, as sometimes happened, the houses were built from dry lumber and the roof was tinder dry shingles, a house could burn to the ground in a very few minutes. If the fire was in the winter time, it was of the utmost importance that all of the occupants of the house, find shelter immediately. They had usually escaped, if at night, in their night clothing, with a coat or a sweater hastily thrown over their shoulders and their barefeet thrust into a pair of rubbers or big boots. The cattle barn provided a refuge from the sub zero weather.

The destitute family had to have help and quickly. The responsibility of providing this, fell upon the shoulders of the father or one of the older boys. He would quickly bridle a horse and without a saddle, ride to the nearest neighbor. There were few people who had telephones in those days, so it was mostly by way of the pony express, that news was conveyed from one home to the next.

It was really quite surprising, how wide a circuit could be covered and of how many people could be contacted in so short a time.

As soon as the news of the burnt out family was public, the neighbors from the district and from miles around, gathered to provide whatever comfort they could. Food and shelter were immediately forthcoming, donations of clothing were made and often contributions of cash were collected toward helping the homeless family. As soon as the start of a new family home could be made, the neighbors got together to volunteer their help, with so many willing hands, it didn't take long till the house was ready for occupancy.

People of that time, trusted one another, this was amply proven by the fact, that those early settlers rarely, if ever locked their doors, day or night. Violent crime, as such, was almost unheard of in the countryside. A person could live alone without fear of being molested or harmed.

It was a peaceful society and people had respect for law and order,

children seldom rebelled against the authority of their parents or teachers, even though at times, those same parents or teachers, could be somewhat tyrannical. The moral code was strict and perhaps a bit rigid, a strong deterrent to misconduct or marriage breakups. Couples married young and divorce was seldom heard of in a society where so many families were related through marriage.

Margrethe suffered a still birth, the summer after Daisy's birth, this was due to the fact that she received a severe jolt, while riding with Jorgen and the family, in a lumber wagon.

She nearly hemorrhaged to death as a result. There were so many accidents that could terminate a pregnancy - a fall, a kick from a cow while milking, lifting a too heavy load of laundry. Women were old before their time. Once more she became pregnant with twins, they were small and weak when they were born - two little boys. The mother was too weak to nurse the babies, so she had to trust the care of them to the midwife and the family. Had they been strong healthy babies, they might have survived, as it was, one child lingered two weeks and gave up the struggle for life. With yearning in her heart, the sorrowing mother feared for her remaining child - two weeks passed and he joined his twin in the sleep of death.

The parents hearts were filled with sadness at the loss of their children. They took comfort at the kindness once again shown by their friends and neighbors. As at the time, when the first little twin passed away, the neighborhood women gathered together at Jorgen's and Margrethe's home in order to extend help and comfort. A casket was needed for the baby and money was scarce. Those large hearted women, lovingly prepared a little box, lined it with the softest of wool, over this, they stitched and lined the little coffin with a white lace curtain, one of the few nice things that Margrethe had left from her homeland. The baby was tenderly and tearfully laid to rest in his little white bed. One of those devoted women, thought to lay little pink flowers, taken from her own houseplant, on top of the lid. The parents still had more heartache in store for them. Little did they think, as they consigned their precious child to the prairie sod, that it

would be only two short weeks, till the little brother would be laid in the same coffin as the first baby was laid. Safely they sleep.

For everything there is an appointed time, even a time for every affair under the heavens, a time for birth and a time to die; a time to plant and a time to uproot what was planted; a time to embrace and a time to keep away from embracing, a time to keep and a time to throw away, a time to seek and a time to give up as lost; a time to keep quiet and a time to speak out; a time to love and a time to hate; a time for war and a time for peace.

While Jorgen pondered on all these things, his heart was heavy within him. Life must go on in spite of grief and disillusionment. He had a wife and five living children dependent on him. He hoped to acquire another quarter of land, that was adjoining his land. He and Margrethe had endured much suffering and hardship since having made this raw new land, their home. He had a feeling of putting down his roots here - a good feeling, for forty years, till the day of his death at the age of eighty, he never wandered far from this spot. He was to outlive Margrethe by half a year - she died at sixty-nine years of age.

In the ensuing years Jorgen was to see great changes in world affairs, there was to be the Wall Street crash in 1929, a stock market event that toppled the financial structure of the whole North American economy. Overnight, millionaires lost their entire fortunes, and being unable to bear their misfortunes, some of them leaped out of the windows from skyscraper buildings.

Just as God's word brings out:

“Those determined to be rich fall into temptation and a snare and many senseless and hurtful desires, which plunge men into destruction and ruin. The love of money is the root of all sorts of injurious things, and by reaching out for this love some have been led astray from the faith and have stabbed themselves all over with many pains”

As a result of plummeting world market prices and in spite of two thirds of the world suffering from under nourishment, the supply exceeded the demand for food supplies. The farmer felt the blow, at times he could not dispose of his produce. Eggs sold at five cents a dozen, cream was fifty cents a gallon, and a full grown beef cow sold for ten dollars.

The grain piled up in the elevators, it was hardly worth the cost of transportation in order to haul it to town. In spite of all this plentitude, people were going hungry in our own country of Canada. There were thousands of unemployed men, young and old. They were forced through hunger, to bum at people's doors for a handout in exchange for a household chore, usually splitting wood or cleaning out a garage or a basement. Many of these so called vagrants, rode the rods from one town to another, were chased by the C.P.R. bulls or cops as they sprang off the freight cars, half frozen and half starved, with nowhere to go. If they were lucky, they might find some hobo jungle, where destitute men assembled in a group, down by the railway tracks. With the price of bread at five cents a loaf and eggs at five cents a dozen, they would pool their few pennies in order to buy these staples. With a fire going, they would boil their eggs and eat their bread in chunks - no butter, no salt. A rough life, a life filled with privation and hardship, it made tough men out of these "bums", yet there was little crime or violence in connection with them, perhaps some petty stealing - "may I not come to poverty that I actually steal".

The government did have a plan, where men could work in a lumber company for their board and room and ten dollars a month, just enough to be able to buy a little tobacco and an odd item of work clothes, boots, socks, underwear, shirt or jacket and a pair of jeans. They made their own amusement, in that some one might own a mouth organ or an ancient fiddle, with which they could entertain in the evenings. The men's only real compensation for their hard manual labor, was that it was healthy work, being that they were out in the open air all day. They slept soundly at nights and there was plenty of food.

These work camps were laid out and administered on much the same principle, as the ones the government built for war dissenters in the 1940's of World War II. That was ten years after the start of the depression and the wheels of industry boomed once more, producing war equipment. The young men that had been unemployed, now marched to war on the battlefields of Europe. Many there were, that never returned.

In the ten years preceding the war, Jorgen and Margrethe had six more children, four boys and one stillborn, and a little girl, Rose, twin sister to the stillborn child. The boys were born only fifteen months apart, Peter, James, John and David. Peter died from peritonitis at the age of four, that was so very sad, in that it could have been prevented. It was difficult to get to a doctor, especially in the winter time, the road was long - it took all of six hours driving time by team and sleigh.

To attempt to get a doctor out from town was equally difficult, even though he drove a car, he could never be certain of getting through to the patient, his fee was twenty-five dollars for the trip and that did not include medication or treatment. As a consequence, many an illness went untreated and the patient died, or as in Peter's case was treated too late, an appendectomy might well have saved his life.

Poor little Peter, he had survived pneumonia before he succumbed to peritonitis, he was a fragile child, with his red hair, blue eyes and delicate complexion. He looked so much like the boy, the first Carl, that the parents had lost when they first came to Canada, eleven years before.

In vain, the parents blamed themselves for not having sought medical help sooner, as it was, it may have been to no avail. The old doctor who attended Peter, advised the mother to lay hot compresses on the abdomen of her child, those compresses only served to rupture the distended appendix. Another doctor, a younger man, was called in and Peter was taken to a hospital in Wetaskiwin, where an emergency operation was performed. It was too late to save Peter's life.

Margrethe's anguish was unspeakable, nothing and no one could console her for the loss of her little boy. This was her Gethsemane and even her God seemed afar off. She was six months pregnant with her twelfth child and David was born three months later. The attending midwife at David's birth, remarked to the father, Jorgen, that he had another son, his reply was "yes, God has sent us another little boy, to take the place of the one whom He took away." The new baby was named David which means beloved.

The mother was long in recovering her strength and health, so for a few months David was given into the care of a childless couple, Martin and Helga.

David was very well cared for and the loving couple would very much have liked to adopt the little boy, of course the parents could in no wise agree to this, no matter what the circumstances were, they had not a child too many. After a few months David came home to live with his family.

Fifteen months after David's birth, Rose and twin arrived, the boy was stillborn. This was to be Margrethe's fourteenth child and her last, she was only thirty-nine. Out of those fourteen children, nine survived her, four boys and five girls.

Rose's birth proved to be a very traumatic experience as the mother very nearly died. She had only a midwife to attend her, the baby girl was delivered without incident, the stillborn baby was retracted. The midwife had no experience in such a case, the labor was prolonged and the mother's strength was failing, she felt herself slipping away. It was a matter of life and death to get a doctor and quickly.

How to get a doctor to drive twenty-five miles on a road that was like gumbo? It had rained most of the night and any driver was just as likely to get mired down or to land up in the ditch. An urgent phone call was made to a doctor in Ponoka, he point blank refused to come. There was only one other doctor in the town, the one that Margrethe held responsible for negligence in Peter's death. In sheer desperation

the doctors in Lacombe and Wetaskiwin were called, they gave the same reply, “sorry we can’t make it.” As a last resort, Peter’s first doctor was contacted, he responded with “I’ll come at once.” He was there within the hour, attended to the exhausted mother and the twin was born. The wheel had turned full circle!

Perhaps the doctor felt that by saving the mother’s life, he had redeemed himself, he had made amends for his ignorance in treating Peter. He had made his atonement and gained back his self-esteem. Margrethe, too, relinquished her former bitterness.

In spite of all of the hardships that the common people had to endure, they survived with unquenchable spirits. They could not travel, they could not buy and drive big cars, they could not afford expensive entertainment, so they provided their own entertainment and found pleasure in the more simple things of everyday life. They got together for community picnics in the summer, they organized sports teams, they had their country fairs, where they showed their best, from farm stock to land and garden produce. The culinary section was well represented, also all home crafts of knitting, sewing, crocheting and embroidery work. There were the Saturday night dances, attended by all and sundry, young and not so young, couples and singles. Church suppers were a specialty and people gathered for fellowship and the simple joy of eating and drinking while enjoying one another’s association.

This was before the era of television, the odd home might have a radio or a crystal set which required the listener to wear a headphone in order to hear what the announcer was saying. News might take a long time to reach outlying places, much of the news was relayed by the grapevine system.

It was during this time of the depression, that Aberhart was the premier of Alberta, he was also a minister of the gospel. He made the radio his media for his Sunday sermons and he had a widespread audience. Not every home was fortunate enough to be able to afford a radio, but to the ones who had, the radio proved a real attraction for their friends and neighbors to come and enjoy “Amos and Andy” or a

hockey game that was broadcast. The odd lonely bachelor was drawn to the warmth and friendliness of these social get togethers, also with perhaps an eye to and the hope of meeting some member of the feminine sex, unattached and willing to be friends. Some friendships, so begun ripened into love and marriage.

The telling of these events, in the life of a rural community, would not be complete, without allowing the young student ministers a memorable place.

They were dedicated young men, not yet ordained and having a couple of years of school of theology. They were supported by their denominational church, their board and room was paid for and they received a very small salary - a mere stipend. Their tenure of apprenticeship, so as to speak, lasted less than three months, mostly through July and August. They rode horseback through the countryside, stopping at each farm along their route, talking with the families and inviting them to their church, which was usually the local school house. Few people accepted the invitation to attend these services and the congregation was made up of a couple of young married people with their very young families and two or three elderly people. The young crowd was usually at the local ball game or off to the lake on Sunday afternoons. A young student minister might have been discouraged unless he took heart from the words of Jesus, "where two or three are gathered in my name."

"Man does not live by bread alone." It was because of the scarcity of any religious teaching or spiritual guidance, for their growing children, that Jorgen and Margrethe sought to remedy this situation. They reasoned that if they bought a car, it would give transportation for the older children of the family to drive into town, where they could attend church services.

They bought a second hand car for the sum of two hundred dollars, this was the price of several head of stock, they could scarcely afford the car. Its purchase could be called a matter of priorities.

It was through the association of one of the young circuit riding student ministers, a Thomas Davis, that the older girls started attending the United Church in Ponoka. The minister was now ordained and was Reverend Davis. It was a long trip into town, fifty miles round trip, and money for gas became increasingly hard to come by - gasoline was twenty-five cents per gallon.

The family may have gained in spirituality but it was sadly out of pocket money when it came to driving expenses, gas, license and upkeep of the motor vehicle. The car was used for two years and then put up on blocks and there it stood for the next year till it was sold for fifty dollars.

The girls had little association with other young people in the neighborhood. The main source of entertainment was the Saturday night dances, the father adamantly refused to let any member of his family attend these. He may have been overly protective of his children but he probably was correct in his estimation of some of the characters that frequented these gatherings. There were a couple of these unsavory personalities who were known to have a still and to make rot gut whiskey. They would bring a couple of bottles of their produce to the dance hall and they would challenge some braggadocio youth to have a swig or two from the bottle. This made for quarrelsome natures and often a free for all brawl was the result. Sometimes there was a scandal, a girl might be persuaded to leave the hall in order to go and sit in a car for awhile. Seduction was often "the name of the game" and a girl's reputation was the price of a moment's thoughtlessness.

They were hard years, between nineteen hundred and thirty and nineteen hundred and thirty-five, and with them went a feeling of hopelessness, the future appeared bleak and dreary with little prospect of improvement. The need for winter clothing became a major item and Eaton's catalogue provided the country people with their absolute necessities, a pair of rubber boots, some long johns, a flannel shirt and some overalls. A mackinaw coat, a cap and a pair of horse hide mitts were expected to last for several seasons. This

outfitted the men and the boys. Margrethe sewed and knitted most of her younger boys clothing, made over from hand me downs that her friends gave her. The youngsters were consequently warmly if not stylishly dressed.

The girls longingly looked through the pages of the catalogue, picturing womens dresses and coats, all that they could hope for, was to be able to send for a few yards of printed voile or rayon. Their mother would sew them dresses from these yard goods. A pair of two dollar sandals was a real luxury and a pair of thirty-five cents rayon stockings, that usually sprang a run at the second wearing.

At times, one of the girls might get a housekeeping job for ten dollars a month. This was during the busy harvest season or perhaps when a new baby was expected in the family and the girl would take over the family duties. The hired girl, as she was called, worked hard for her ten dollars or less a month. She had to be up at six o'clock, cook breakfast for the family, do the cleaning of the house, wash, iron, bake, cook, can, besides preparing and serving lunch and supper. There was always the odd jobs, such as weeding the garden, washing or painting walls and babysitting in the evenings. She would have one afternoon off a week, usually Sunday afternoon and she was free till Monday morning. Unless she had a boyfriend that would come and take her out, life was rather lonely for a young girl. The money that she earned had to cover her needs and at times she would be expected to help her family at home. The sisters were very grateful for whatever their working sister's generosity allowed.

While Anne was finishing her high school, she took over the job of doing the janitor work for the school, she got paid two dollars a month. The job required that she carry in the wood, several armloads were needed for the day, the wood pile was replenished every fall, also starting the fire in the big drum heater, every school day morning. The floor had to be swept every night and the school desks lined up in a straight row and dusted once a week, usually on Fridays. Once in mid term, two of the sisters were asked if they wanted the job of scrubbing the wooden floor and twenty four desks, also the teacher's

desk and chair.

They accepted the job and received the munificent sum of two dollars for a hard day's work. There was even a complaint, that the windows hadn't been washed. The windows were not washed because it was a frigid day in January and the wash rag froze to the window as soon as it touched its surface.

The little one room frame schoolhouse, whose trustees hired a new teacher for every school year, quite a succession of teachers, some very young and inexperienced, some a little more mature and with a genuine desire to instill a love of knowledge into their pupils, a few, truly dedicated to teach and inspire to reach out for ideals beyond the ordinary everyday line of vision. A teacher might nourish and foster the potential spark of creativity in a child and from the ranks of some of these country school children have come some of the leaders of their country.

The role of the rural teacher was not an easy one, sometimes they had to teach all the grades from one to eleven, all in one room. He or she did not have much time to devote to any one pupil or class. Assignments were passed out to the children, and with the aid of their textbooks, they more or less worked on their own. This procedure had one big advantage, it taught the pupil to research his material, it taught independent thinking, how to summarize.

The little one room school was soon to be on the decline and the consolidated school was to take its place. The children that every school day had been used to walk the mile or two to school, had now only to hop on the school bus that stopped at their driveway gate, quite a change! One step of progress leads to another, with the coming of the school bus came also, the building of better roads, where before the roads had been only dirt, they now were gravelled and graded.

Though jobs were hard to come by during the depression years, this did not discourage couples from marrying young, a girl might marry at seventeen or eighteen and a boy three or four years older.

They would usually have a baby within the first year of marriage, followed closely by brothers and sisters, the average family included three or four children.

People may have found it hard to make ends meet but families stuck together and divorce was an almost unheard of thing in the average working class of society. The children from this society may have lacked in some of the amenities but they more than compensated for that lack by the security of knowing that each was a cog in the wheel of the family unit, each indispensable to the whole, yet nevertheless interdependent. It has been stated that the family is the nucleus of our society, then surely a nation is only as sound as the integrality of its homes.

Jorgen was to live through a second world war, he would be able to, by switching on his television, see the atrocities that took place half a world away. This deadly struggle for world supremacy, before it was over in nineteen hundred and forty-five, was to claim millions of lives and cost well over a trillion dollars, not to mention the millions of blasted lives and all the untold human misery and utter desolation that it left in its wake. Surely it proved, “man’s inhumanity to man.”

The two atomic bombs, dropped on Nagasaki and Hiroshima brought all resistance to an end. The aftermath was horrendous, beyond scope of the imagination and the morale collapse of a nation was complete.

Jorgen had only one son that was old enough to have been inducted into the army, he wasn’t as he was a farmer. The country had need of its agricultural workers to feed its armies, at home and abroad.

As a result of the war and its demands for manpower, food and munitions, the market prices for farm products had risen accordingly.

Where five years previously, a milk cow sold for ten dollars, the producer now received fifty dollars. As so much farm production was shipped overseas in order to feed the troops, the government put a

curb on home consumption by issuing food ration coupons to every family. The rations also extended to gasoline and tires. The foods that were rationed included meat and fats, also sugar, butter, coffee, tea, cocoa and soap.

There was now some money available to buy a few of the essentials that the family had done without through the hard and bitter years of the depression. Manufactured goods were in short supply as every ounce of manpower and energy was directed toward the race to produce more armaments.

Jorgen's and Margrethe's family was complete. There was enough of an income now, so that each of the three boys could have a bicycle to ride, as they grew up, a couple of them acquired motorcycles and many was the hairbrained stunt that they practised at the risk of life and limb.

Daisy enjoyed riding her horse, she could jump on a horse bareback without a lift, from the time that she was knee high to a grasshopper.

There was a span of nineteen years between the eldest and the youngest of the children. Jorgen's and Margrethe's three eldest daughters were now married and they had young families of their own. The grandchildren enjoyed their visits to the farm, seeing the farm animals and running barefoot through the grass, on those warm summer days. Those were carefree times for them.

They were right in their element, snug and secure in the large family circle, of which they were an integral part and surrounded as they were by parents, grandparents, brothers, sisters, aunts, uncles and cousins.

The sense of permanence that an individual gets from belonging to a home and family can never be underestimated, the quality of loyalty to ones own. The strength of family unity would provide a bulwark against life's many vicissitudes in the years to come. Difficult years - many of them!

Jorgen and Margrethe were to live long enough to see fifty or more of their descendants, Margrethe died in December of nineteen hundred and sixty-one and Jorgen died the following June. Had Margrethe lived another six months, she and Jorgen would have celebrated their golden wedding - fifty years of married life.

They sleep side by side, their resting place, marked only by a single grey marble stone. Their two little boys, Carl and Peter, lie in unmarked graves - there also rests a grandson, Donald. Peacefully they sleep, kept secure in God's memory, until the great and glorious resurrection morning of that new world, which they saw, only as a vision of the future. (Also there lies Margaret, a granddaughter.)

For this, they strove, they overcame, they conquered and they could say along with Job, "I know that my Redeemer lives, and that coming after me he will rise up over the dust."

One generation goes and another generation comes and the meek will inherit the earth and they will live to see their children and their children's children delight themselves in the exquisite fullness of peace.

Jorgen's and Margrethe's children remember their parents as being part of that time of their young lives, where morals and values were instilled and inculcated into them, both by precept and example.

They inspired their children with a sense of worth and of self-esteem, encouraged them to be honest and fair in all of their dealings, to be kind and considerate in all of their relationships and above all, to keep their integrity in all things.

This account, written by Jorgen's and Margrethe's eldest daughter, is a tribute to all of the people who formed a part of that generation, to which they were a part. If it is true - that suffering and adversity builds refinement and character, then those early settlers should be a sterling race. They sank their roots deeply into the fertile soil of their environment and tenaciously they clung and braved all hazards. They strove mightily, they suffered fiercely, they endured endlessly, some time in spite of all efforts, they failed miserably and saw the ruin of their hopes and ambitions. They were a valiant breed, indomitable

in spirit and dauntless in faith and fortitude. They were to see the fruits of their labors and to enjoy the blossoming of their hopes and dreams.

Theirs were the grass roots, that produced a well cultivated and productive land, theirs, the accomplishment of seeing a well established community spring up from their combined resources. These selfsame people were the very backbone of the society of their time, they would live to form the very nucleus of a strong and democratic nation wherein many generations of multinational groups might find and put down their roots and in turn produce a diverse and variegated culture, wherein each group might yet be free to express their own style and individuality.

In the end, each becomes a part of a pattern, that stretches like a tapestry across a screen, to form and become a great mosaic of the whole, suffusing and blending, until there is no longer any distinction of line or color but each complementing and enhancing the other until it becomes one in its entirety, vast and unparalleled in scope and perception, finally losing itself in a sense of continuity to time indefinite!

Following is a list of Jorgen's and Margrethe's direct descendants.

Esther married Viktor Petersen

Born to them three daughters - Elaine - Linda - Joy

Ethel married Einer Andersen

Born to them three sons - David - Richard - Jerry

Anne married Aage Frandsen

Born to them two sons and one daughter - Eric - Sylvia - Donald

Carl married Gladys Smithson

Born to them three sons and one daughter - Margrethe - Randolph - David - Edmund

Daisy married George Dalgarno

Born to them four sons and four daughters - George - Patricia - Sidney - Bonnie - Linda - Debra - Larry - Mark

James married Mary Shwed

John married Betty Hackett

Born to them three sons and two daughters - Gordon - Beverly - Timothy - Karen - Leonard

David married Pauline Burnett

Born to them two daughters - Kathleen - Melissa
David also has a son by a former marriage, Adelbert

Rose married Victor Forseth

Born to them five daughters - Elaine - Donna - Janet - Verna - June

